RNI NO.: DELENG/2005/15351

Millennium post

No Half Truths

millenniumpost.in | millenniumpost | MillenniumPost | mpostdigital

PUBLISHED FROM DELHI | KOLKATA | SILIGURI | TUESDAY, SEPTEMBER 29, 2026 | NEW DELHI | PAGES 14 | Rs 4.00 | VOL.21, ISSUE 270



'UDYOG MITRA BRINGS BUSINESS APPROVALS UNDER ONE ROOF' P3



J&K ASSEMBLY PASSES STATEHOOD RESOLUTION AMID PROTESTS BY BJP P5

'TOUGH TO HAVE THIS VERSION OF BRUCE OUTSIDE OF THAT WORLD' P14

Delhi draws up battle plan for smog

Entry curbs, higher parking fees, 50% WFH, construction ban among key measures

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 28

With winter pollution months approaching, the Delhi government has lined up a tighter enforcement and monitoring regime, including 50 per cent work-from-home, doubled parking charges, staggered office timings, stricter PUCC compliance, an expansion of its air-quality monitoring network from 47 to 60 stations, and a phased ban on construction and demolition activities from November.

The measures were announced after a meeting chaired by Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav at Paryavaran Bhawan on Monday, attended by Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa, PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh and senior officials. The government said the Winter Action Plan 2026-27 would focus on prevention, enforcement, technology-based monitoring and public participation.

Parking charges, office timings to change

From November 1, parking charges CONTINUED ON P4



COURT ASKS, TAX OR FEE, OR WHAT?

SC questions legal basis of UPI MDR charges, refuses interim stay

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

The Supreme Court on Monday questioned the legal basis for imposing merchant discount rate (MDR) on certain UPI merchant payments above Rs 2,000, asking the Centre to explain whether the charge was a tax, a fee or something else. The court, however, declined to stay the levy, which is scheduled to take effect from October 15.

A bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana issued notices to the Centre, Reserve Bank of India (RBI) and National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) on a PIL challenging the framework. The respondents have been given four weeks to file their responses.

During the hearing, Additional Solicitor General N Venkataraman told the court that 96 per cent of UPI users would remain outside the levy and that the government would not receive any part of the money collected.



CLOSER LOOK

- SC questions Centre over 'expropriation'
- MDR begins October 15
- 0.4% MDR applies above Rs 2,000
- Charges apply to specified merchant transactions
- SC issues notices to Centre, RBI, NPCI
- Respondents get four weeks to reply
- Government says it gets no MDR money

"The Government of India is not taking even a single rupee out of it," he said. The bench sought a detailed affidavit explaining the basis for the charge. CONTINUED ON P4

Sensex, Nifty tumble over 5% in past month, erode Rs 17.17 lakh crore

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 28

Benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty have lost more than 5 per cent in the past month as rising crude oil prices, geopolitical tensions, higher bond yields and expectations of tighter US monetary policy weighed on investors.

Since August 27, the 30-share BSE Sensex has fallen 4,161.87 points, or 5.40 per cent, while the NSE Nifty has declined 1,310.6 points, or 5.44 per cent. The fall reduced investors' wealth by Rs 17,17,487.02 crore to Rs 4,74,36,620.19 crore, equivalent to USD 4.94 trillion.

The sell-off intensified on Monday, when the Sensex dropped 1,124.02 points, or 1.52 per cent, to 72,771.72, its lowest closing level since March 30, 2026. The Nifty fell 360.25 points, or 1.56 per cent, to 22,780.25, marking a near six-month low. CONTINUED ON P4

SC suggests electricity bill route to recover unpaid traffic challans

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 28

With nearly Rs 20,000 crore in unpaid traffic fines piling up across the country, the Supreme Court on Monday suggested an unusual way to recover the money: add outstanding e-challans to electricity bills and disconnect power for non-payment.

A bench of Justices J B Pardiwala and K V Viswanathan was told that states and Union territories had issued e-challans worth about Rs 45,000 crore, but recovered only around Rs 25,000 crore. The bench said merely issuing challans had little purpose if penalties were not collected. CONTINUED ON P4

Tata Trusts propose merger plan to keep Tata Sons unlisted

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, September 28

Tata Trusts, which hold a 66 per cent stake in Tata Sons, have proposed merging two operating companies with the group's holding company in a move that could allow Tata Sons to exit the Reserve Bank of India's regulatory framework for non-banking financial companies and avoid a stock-market listing.

The proposal involves Tata Electronics Systems Solutions Pvt Ltd (TESS) and Tata Consulting Engineers (TCE) being merged into Tata Sons. The Trusts have asked the Tata Sons board to consider the plan and seek a prior no-objection certificate from the RBI.

According to the Trusts, the restructured entity would have operating revenue of Rs 1,05,043 crore as of March 31, 2026, accounting for 64.3 per cent of total income. Income from financial assets would be Rs 40,072 crore, while net assets would total Rs 2,00,158 crore. Investments in Tata Group companies would stand at Rs 1,77,120 crore, below 90 per cent of net assets.

The Trusts said the structure would ensure Tata Sons no longer qualifies as either an NBFC or a core investment company. It would then surrender its certificate of registration as a CIC. SEE P9

SUO MOTU COGNISANCE OF CRIME AGAINST WOMEN

'Systematic failure': SC orders dedicated police teams to monitor vulnerable zones

Demands accountability on sex offender database

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

The Supreme Court on Monday took suo motu cognisance of recent cases of crimes against women and minor girls in Delhi-NCR, observing that the incidents, viewed alongside other reports of sexual offences, indicated a systematic failure of law enforcement and civil administrative authorities to guarantee basic public safety. A bench of Justices J B Pardiwala and K Vinod Chandran said the alleged gang rape and murder of a teenage girl in Swaroop Nagar, the alleged gang rape of a 17-year-old at Aastha Kunj Park and the alleged sexual assault of a minor inside a moving sleeper bus that travelled over 47 km from Greater Noida to Delhi raised questions about whether systemic law enforcement mechanisms had made meaningful progress since the 2012 Nirbhaya case. The court said public authorities must move beyond expressions of concern and ensure measurable responses with responsibility and accountability fixed on those entrusted with preventing crime, maintaining public order and protecting vulnerable persons.

The bench said the right to live with dignity and free from fear of violence is an intrinsic facet of the right to life under Article 21 of CONTINUED ON P4

KEY POINTS

- Delhi Police Commissioner directed to constitute dedicated teams in every district, headed by an officer not below DSP rank, within four weeks
- Teams will identify vulnerable locations using NCRB data, local intelligence, complaints and previous incidents
- Appropriate arrangements ordered at vulnerable areas and public parks, particularly during evening and early morning hours

India approves Asad Alam Siam as B'desh's High Commissioner

VINAY KUMAR
New Delhi, September 28

India has approved the appointment of Bangladesh Foreign Secretary Asad Alam Siam to become the country's next High Commissioner to India. The approval by the host country paves the way for a change in Dhaka's diplomatic representation in New Delhi. Siam is expected to take up the assignment after completing the required formalities.



He will replace M Riaz Hamidullah, who is set to move to Geneva as Bangladesh's Permanent Representative to the United Nations. Siam, a career diplomat who joined Bangladesh's Foreign Service in 1995, has held several important diplomatic positions during his career. He previously served as Bangladesh's ambassador to the United States, Austria and the Philippines and has also worked at the country's missions in Milan, Manchester, Jakarta and Bangkok.

He became Bangladesh's Foreign Secretary in June 2025 and has remained closely involved in the country's foreign policy and international engagements.

His appointment indicates the priority and willingness of the new government in Dhaka to reset ties and explore ways to restore CONTINUED ON P4

Collegium recommends three Chief Justices for elevation to Top Court

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 28

The Supreme Court Collegium on Monday recommended the elevation of three High Court Chief Justices to the Supreme Court, setting in motion the process for their appointment as apex court judges.

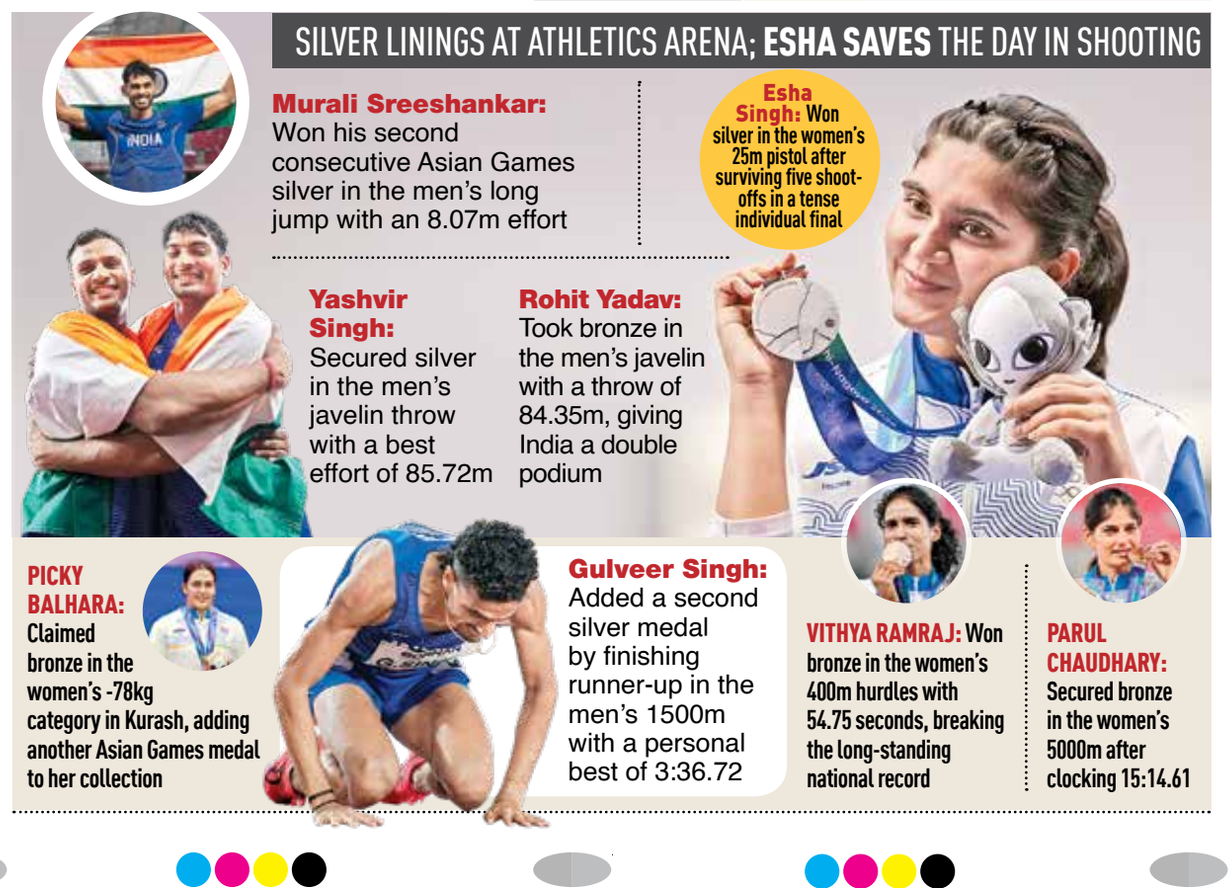
The recommendations include Justice Sunita Agarwal, Chief Justice of the Gujarat High Court, Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya, Chief Justice of the Delhi High Court, and Justice Aparesh Kumar Singh, Chief Justice of the High Court for the State of Telangana.

The decision was taken at a meeting of the Collegium comprising Chief Justice of India and Justices Vikram Nath, B V Nagarathna, M M Sundresh and P S Narasimha.

The Collegium's resolution formally records the recommendation of the three judges for elevation to the Supreme Court. Their names will now move through the established procedure governing appointments to the apex court.

The recommendations come as part of the Collegium's constitutional role in selecting judges for elevation to the Supreme Court. Further steps in the appointment process will follow the prescribed procedure.

ASIAN GAMES 2026 GOLD: 4 | SILVER: 20 | BRONZE: 21



Ujjain on boil over mosque demolition

HC disposes of pleas by Muslim side after they cite settlement with civic body

MPOST BUREAU
Ujjain (MP), September 28

Tensions flared in Ujjain on Monday as police fired tear gas to disperse a crowd that pelted stones during a protest against the proposed removal of a portion of the 100-year-old Shahi Masjid for a road-widening project ahead of the Simhastha Kumbh 2028, even as the Madhya Pradesh High Court disposed of two appeals after the mosque management and Ujjain Municipal Corporation reached an agreement on the issue. Police said some people were arrested, 15 detained and a case registered against seven persons, including social media influencers accused of posting inflammatory messages and inciting people. Superintendent of Police Pradeep Sharma said police initially tried to persuade the protesters to cooperate CONTINUED ON P4



Security personnel keep vigil following stone-pelting incidents during protests in Ujjain PTI

YEIDA clears major logistics & industrial infrastructure plans

Records 182% rise in receipts till September

DIPIKA KIROLA
Greater Noida, September 28

The Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority (YEIDA) has approved a series of measures aimed at strengthening industrial, logistics and civic infrastructure in the region around Noida International Airport on Monday.

The decisions were taken at the Authority's 93rd board meeting, where officials also reviewed the progress of industrial parks and approved a mechanism to build a dedicated corpus fund for long-term maintenance of civic infrastructure.

Among the major decisions was the proposed development of a 200 acre multi-modal logistics park at Tappal-Bajna. According to YEIDA CEO RK Singh, land for the project will be offered to eligible investors through e-auction.

"The initiative will boost investment, employment and modern supply-chain infrastructure in the Yamuna area and help develop the region as a major logistics hub," Singh said.

The Authority is also working on plans for a much larger industrial node spread across around 8,000 hectares to the south of Noida International Airport. YEIDA is in the process of appointing a consultant to prepare the master plan for the proposed industrial zone.



93RD BOARD MEET

- 'Initiative will boost investment, employment and modern supply-chain infrastructure in the Yamuna area and help develop the region as a major logistics hub,' Singh said
- The Authority is also working on plans for a much larger industrial node spread across around 8,000 hectares to the south of Noida International Airport
- YEIDA is in the process of appointing a consultant to prepare the master plan for the proposed industrial zone

Officials said the industrial node is expected to attract fresh investments and create employment while strengthening logistics infrastructure and giving further momentum to planned industrial development around the airport.

Meanwhile, YEIDA has finalised its Corpus Fund Investment Regulation 2026-27 to ensure the long-term financial sustainability of civic infrastructure. Under the mechanism, one time lease rent and other eligible non-recurring receipts will be transferred to a corpus fund and invested in accordance with prescribed rules.

The interest generated from these investments, along with permissible amounts received from them will be utilised for the repair and maintenance of roads, water supply, sewerage and drainage networks, street lighting, parks, green belts and other civic facilities in the Authority area.

The board also reviewed the progress of industrial plot allotments Of 295 industrial plots measuring more than 4,000 sqm, lease deeds have been executed for 181 plots, while possession has been handed over for 152. Construction has begun on 69 plots and production has started at 13 units.

In the Medical Device Park in Sector 28, 123 of the 203 plots have been allotted. Possession has been given for 75 plots and construction has started on 28. Work is also underway on common facilities such as a 3D prototype lab, electronics assembly facility, biomaterial facility, common IT facility and tooling room

In Sector 29, 159 plots have been allotted in the Apparel Park, while 503 plots have been allotted in the MSME Park and 188 in the Handicraft Park.

YEIDA has also reported a significant increase in its receipts. Its total receipts up to September stood at Rs 4,222 crore in 2026-27, against Rs 1,495 crore during the corresponding period of 2025-26, registering a rise of around 182 per cent. The Authority's expenditure also increased substantially, from Rs 333 crore during the corresponding period last year to Rs 5,501 crore this year. Officials said the bulk of the expenditure was towards land acquisition and repayment of loans.

OVER 10,500 SQ METRES FOR GGM METRO

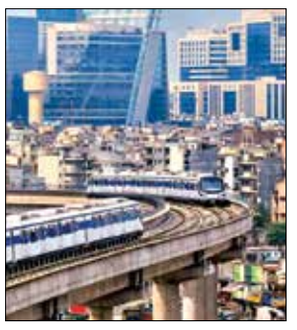
Landowners' refusal pushes Hry towards Metro land acquisition

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Gurugram, September 28

The Haryana government has decided to acquire private land required for the Gurugram Metro corridor under the Land Acquisition, Rehabilitation and Resettlement Act, 2013, after most landowners declined to sell their parcels under the state's direct purchase policy, officials said.

The decision was taken at a high-powered committee meeting chaired by Haryana chief secretary Anurag Rastogi last month. The committee also directed agencies to ensure that utilities falling along the alignment of Phase One, from Millennium City Centre to Sector 9, are shifted within the stipulated timelines.

The Gurugram Metro Rail Limited (GMRL) requires more than 10,500 square metres of land across Islampur, Basai and Kanhai. The requirement includes 8,600 square metres in Islampur, 1,696 square metres in Basai and 534 square metres in Kanhai.



DESPITE SEVERAL MEETINGS WITH LANDOWNERS, ONLY A FEW HAD AGREED TO SELL THEIR LAND...

Despite several meetings with landowners, only a few had agreed to sell their land under the direct purchase policy. Owners had sought higher compensation, alternative plots and jobs in the metro, while multiple ownership of several parcels also made negotiations difficult.

The urban estates department will now initiate the acquisition process under the 2013 Act. Compensation is linked to the market value of the land and can be up to four times the market value in rural areas and twice in urban areas, subject to applicable provisions. Eligible affected families are also entitled to rehabilitation and resettlement benefits.

In May, around 8,653.63 square metres in Islampur was earmarked, along with 1,695.74 square metres in Basai and 534 square metres in Kanhai.

The committee also directed agencies to shift utilities. NHAI will shift power feeders and a water pipeline by December 31, while GMDA has asked the gas pipeline utility to complete the work by October 31.

HC seeks jail response on Sharjeel Imam's plea to access e-record to complete PhD

Nov 2 for next hearing: Court

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

The Delhi High Court on Monday sought the response of jail authorities on a plea by student activist Sharjeel Imam, who is in custody in a February 2020 northeast Delhi riots case, seeking access to research material stored on a pen drive to complete his PhD.

Justice Sanjeev Narula issued notice to the jail authorities and directed them to file a status report in the matter. The court fixed November 2 for next hearing.

Imam has sought access to research material on a pen drive using a standalone computer inside the prison premises, without any internet connectivity and under the supervision of Tihar jail staff.

Imam's counsel said he has been in custody since January 2020 and was in the final year of his PhD at the time of his arrest. His synopsis has been approved by the University Grants Commission (UGC) and Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU), he added.

Delhi Police did not oppose Imam's plea, while jail authorities objected only to the pen drive.

Imam was arrested in 2020 under UAPA over the riots conspiracy.

Police chief reviews park security

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar on Monday visited the Pink Booth at LSR College, National Park and Arun Jaitley Park in Hauz Khas to review security arrangements.

Accompanied by senior officers, including Special CP Neeraj Thakur and DCP South Anant Mittal, Kumar patrolled the park and adjoining areas and directed enhanced patrolling and security measures.



BSES focuses on BESS safety prep

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

BSES organised a three-day workshop on the Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) Safety Framework, bringing together power-sector leaders, global safety experts, utilities, fire and emergency services and industry professionals.

The workshop focused on safety-by-design, early warning systems, thermal runaway, recognised testing, emergency preparedness, evacuation protocols and first-responder readiness.

A key highlight was a live thermal runaway demonstration involving a battery module, followed by a firefighting exercise by Delhi Fire Service personnel.

Experts from UL Standards & Engagement and Intotech discussed system testing, failure modes, manufacturing defects, battery ageing, fire safety and emergency response.

The programme concluded with nine multidisciplinary teams working through emergency scenarios involving smoke, flooding and post-fire dismantling and waste management.

BSES also highlighted its 20 MW/40 MWh Kilokri BESS.

BETWEEN LIGHT



People silhouette against the sky during sunset near Vijay Chowk, in New Delhi PTI

48-yr-old motorcyclist killed in Dehradun Expressway accident

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, September 28

A 48-year-old motorcyclist was killed and another person injured after their motorcycle collided with a dumpster truck on the Dehradun Expressway in east Delhi's Laxmi Nagar area, police said.

The incident took place around 10.31pm on September 27 near the overbridge opposite the SDM Office on the Dehradun-bound carriageway. A PCR call regarding the collision was received at Laxmi Nagar Police Station, following which a police team reached the spot and found the motorcycle and truck in an accident-damaged condition.

MOTORCYCLIST, IDENTIFIED AS SHIV KUMAR, WAS TAKEN TO DR HEDGEWAR HOSPITAL, WHERE HE WAS DECLARED BROUGHT DEAD

The motorcyclist, identified as Shiv Kumar, was taken to Dr Hedgewar Hospital, where doctors declared him brought dead. Another person, identified as Chandan Gupta, also sustained injuries and was taken to a hospital. His condition was not immediately known.

Police inspected the accident site and photographed the vehicles as part of the investigation. The vehicles involved were also examined.

An FIR has been registered at Laxmi Nagar Police Station under Sections 106(1), 281 and 125(a) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS). The sections relate to causing death by negligence, rash or negligent driving on a public way, and acts endangering the life or personal safety of others.

Police are investigating the circumstances leading to the collision and verifying the sequence of events. Further investigation is underway.

OCTOBER 2

AISA-led group plans Jantar Mantar protest

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

An AISA-led group of activists, academics and political representatives on Monday announced a protest at Jantar Mantar on October 2, days after Delhi Police detained demonstrators at the site over electoral roll revision.

Led by AISA president Neha Bora, the group submitted an intimation letter seeking Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation.

The delegation included Yogendra Yadav, Prashant Bhushan, Manoj Jha, Nikhil Dey and Nandita Narain. Organisers raised concerns over SIR, Form 6 and alleged voter exclusions.

RAIN FAILS TO DETER WOMEN'S SAFETY MARCH

DU students march against violence, curfews

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 28

The relentless downpour over Delhi's North Campus on September 28 failed to dampen a sea of red banners and echoing chants. Marching under the banner 'Hum Auratein Aazad Hain' (We Women Are Free), hundreds of students from Delhi University and beyond took to the streets to protest the harrowing gang rape of a 17-year-old girl in Kalkaji. Rejecting state-imposed curfews and victim-blaming rhetoric, the women-and-queer-only protest transformed grief into fierce, collective defiance.

Organised independently with no political party affiliation, the mobilisation began outside Miranda House Gate No. 7. Marching down Chhatra Marg past pouring rain, demonstrators converged at the Faculty of Arts, chanting powerful slogans like "Toodh kar rakhdo woh samaaj naari jisme bhandhi hai aaj" and "Inquilab zindabaad" demanding absolute male accountability.

Student leaders emphasised that the outrage is rooted in years of unaddressed systemic neglect. Shrestha, a BA History Honours student at Miranda House, pointed out the absurdity of institutional responses. "We are only here for the women of this country who are suffering in a zone where their safety isn't even offered by government. But what are they doing? Shutting parks, switching classes online. Is this the solution in a new development era?" she asked, criticising leaders and PM's remark of cultural shock on women language and focus on policing women's movements rather than curbing systemic violence.



STUDENT LEADERS EMPHASISED THAT THE OUTRAGE IS ROOTED IN YEARS OF UNADDRESSED SYSTEMIC NEGLECT

Echoing this sentiment, Lakshmi Bai College President Tammana Dabas stood alongside protesters near the Dr. B.R. Ambedkar statue, declaring, "We won't stop fighting against these crimes. If crimes against women don't stop in this country, we will come up in huge numbers and fight against the injustice."

For alumni and supporters, the trauma is deeply personal. Akruti, an alumnus, recalled harrowing incidents of harassment near college gates that continue to haunt students, noting that police apathy only deepens the crisis. CJP spokesperson Ratna Singh underscored that legal frameworks alone are insufficient without a fundamental shift in mindset. Advocating for preventive accountability, she remarked, "Har ghar 'Samajhdaar Ladke Yojna' should be launched, because teaching boys respect, consent, and accountability is just as important as making laws."

From North Campus to LSR and Kamala Nehru College down south, the student movement has made it clear: safety is a non-negotiable right, not a privilege governed by curfews.

'Habitual cheat' posing as politician's spouse held for Rs 1.69L fraud

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

A 44-year-old "habitual cheat" was arrested for allegedly duping a Dwarka-based businessman of Rs 1.69 lakh by posing as the spouse of a prominent politician, police said on Monday.

The accused, Bhalinder Pal Singh, allegedly told the businessman that a student's fee had to be paid urgently as the person responsible was on leave, promising reimbursement through the office. Believing the claim, the businessman transferred the money to different bank accounts and also booked a Delhi-Lucknow flight ticket.

Police said Singh used the Ashoka emblem as his messaging app profile picture to create an impression of official authority. He allegedly used fake identities in earlier cheating cases, posing as a mayor, an MLA's personal assistant and an MP's relative.

An FIR was registered at Dwarka South Police Station on September 13. Police traced Singh through the IP address used to create the messaging account and arrested him from Gurugram's Sector 43, where he allegedly lived as Jasraj Sehgal. Two Aadhaar cards bearing the same number were recovered. Singh has been involved in 25 cases and declared a proclaimed offender in four.

Although every possible care and caution has been taken to avoid errors or omissions, this publication is being sold on the condition and understanding that information given in this publication is merely for reference and must not be taken as having authority of or binding in any way on the writers, editors, publishers, and printers and sellers who do not owe any responsibility for any damage or loss to any person, a purchaser of this publication or not for the result of any action taken on the basis of this work. All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent court and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only

Printed and Published by Jaiyendra Kumar Sharma on behalf of Front Row Media Pvt. Ltd. and printed at The Indian Express Pvt. Ltd., A-8, Sector-7, Noida-201 301 (U.P.) and published from First Floor, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002. Editor: Durbar Ganguly. Email: editor@millenniumpost.in, Tel. No. 011-47777500, Kolkata office: Room No 1,15th Floor, Chatterjee International Centre, 33A Jawaharlal Nehru Road, Kolkata 700071 West Bengal, Siliguri Office: Techno India Group Zonal Office G-212, 2nd Floor Office Block - City Centre Matigara District Darjeeling Pin - 734010 Phone- 0353- 2576321

'Udyog Mitra' brings business approvals under one roof: CM

21 more depts, 100 services to join portal next month

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday launched the 'Delhi Udyog Mitra' portal under the ease of doing business initiative to bring multiple approvals and No Objection Certificates (NOCs) under one umbrella.

The single-window portal will promote ease of doing business and help industrialists and entrepreneurs apply for different licences and NOCs through it, Industries Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa said.

More than 15 departments and 50 services have been onboarded on the platform. By next month, another 21 departments and more than 100 services will be onboarded, he told reporters.

The portal will also provide necessary information to entrepreneurs and industrialists who will not have to make rounds of different offices to obtain permissions, Sirsa said.

Applicants will also be able to track the status of their applications filed through the portal. Grievances will also be lodged on it, the minister said.

A helpline number (7827079696) will be available to address grievances from businesspersons and entrepreneurs regarding the single-window system. Complaints would also be lodged through the helpline number.

The portal is expected to provide easier and more convenient access to government services for over 8 lakh traders in Delhi, including MSMEs. The online platform has also been integrated with the National Single Window System (NSWS), allowing investors and businesses to access approvals at both the central and state levels, said a Delhi CMO statement.

The portal's important features include availing services of different departments through a Single Sign-On (SSO) login. The Common Application Form (CAF) will reduce the need for applicants to repeatedly submit the same basic information.

The 'Know Your Approvals' (KYA) feature will help entrepreneurs identify the approvals required for their proposed business. Through the applicant dashboard, users will be able to view the status of their applications in one place.

The guidance module will also provide FAQs, manuals and information related to services, helping entrepreneurs understand the required process before submitting an application, the statement said.

The Chief Minister said that the ease of doing business is not limited to putting processes online and added it is about creating a system based on trust, transparency and convenience between the government and the business community.

The 'Delhi Udyog Mitra Portal' is an important reform in this direction, she emphasised.

The government will further expand the 'Delhi Udyog Mitra Portal' through service integration, process simplification and digital transformation, she added.

SINGLE WINDOW

- The portal will also provide necessary information to entrepreneurs and industrialists who will not have to make rounds of different offices to obtain permissions, Sirsa said
- A helpline number (7827079696) will be available to address grievances from businesspersons and entrepreneurs regarding the single-window system. Complaints would also be lodged through the helpline number
- Applicants will be able to track the status of applications filed through the portal. Grievances will also be lodged on it

L-G asks cops, civic agencies to strengthen women's safety

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, September 28



"THE PWD, NDMC AND MCD WERE ASKED TO SECURE ROADS THROUGH ADEQUATE STREET LIGHTING AND ELIMINATE DARK SPOTS

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Monday directed the Delhi Police and civic agencies to step up security measures for women across the capital, with particular focus on vulnerable stretches, public parks, roads, educational institutions and public transport.

Chairing a high-level meeting to review measures being undertaken by government departments and agencies, Sandhu directed the Delhi Police to substantially increase on-ground engagement with students in schools and colleges, heads of educational institutions, RWAs and MTAs.

He said such interactions should be conducted at least at the level of DCPs, Additional DCPs, ACPs and SHOs, with concerns raised by these groups addressed at the earliest.

The L-G also directed the Delhi Police to intensify visible patrolling at vulnerable sites and asked the DDA, MCD and PWD to ensure adequate lighting, security personnel and secured boundaries in parks and other public spaces, besides eliminating dark spots.

Heads and chiefs of agencies were asked to personally inspect major parks in their respective jurisdictions. Sandhu also directed that parks and public spaces should not be closed to citizens in the name of security.

The PWD, NDMC and MCD were asked to secure roads through adequate street lighting and eliminate dark spots, while the Transport Department was directed to secure buses and other vehicles, as instructed earlier, and ensure adequate lighting at bus stands.

Measures being undertaken by the DDA, MCD and NDMC to strengthen park security and address broken boundaries were also reviewed.

Sandhu cautioned that any laxity would be viewed seriously and appropriate disciplinary action would be taken against officers found guilty of dereliction of duty.

The meeting was attended by the Chief Secretary, Commissioner (MCD), Chairperson (NDMC), Principal Secretary (Education), VC (DDA) and Vice-Chancellor, Delhi University.

SECURITY REVIEW

- He said such interactions should be conducted at least at the level of DCPs, Additional DCPs, ACPs and SHOs, with concerns raised by these groups addressed at the earliest
- The L-G also directed the Delhi Police to intensify visible patrolling at vulnerable sites and asked the DDA, MCD and PWD to ensure adequate lighting, security personnel and secured boundaries in parks and other public spaces...
- Heads and chiefs of agencies were asked to personally inspect major parks in their respective jurisdictions. L-G Sandhu also directed that parks and public spaces should not be closed to citizens in the name of security

BLOs will collect documents from homes of electors issued notices

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

The Delhi poll body on Monday said booth-level officers (BLOs) will collect documents from the homes of voters issued notices over "discrepancies" during the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

The move aims to make the hearing process more convenient and reduce visits to electoral registration officer (ERO) and assistant ERO offices, an official statement said. BLOs will upload the documents on ECINet for the ERO's decision, and such electors will not be required to attend hearings.

Hearings will be held only in exceptional cases, preferably online, while an adult family member may attend on an elector's behalf.

The Election Commission has extended the deadline for claims and objections by a month to October 30, with disposal by November 30 and final rolls to be published on December 4.

The draft rolls contain over 97 lakh voters, while notices have been issued to more than 33 lakh over discrepancies. Special enrolment camps will also be held at educational institutions on September 29 and 30.

Woman stabbed to death with butcher's knife; husband on run

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

A 30-year-old woman was stabbed to death with a butcher's knife by her husband in southwest Delhi's Palam area after she allegedly confronted him over his alleged affair, police said on Monday.

The accused, identified as 35-year-old Pradeep, allegedly attacked his wife with the knife during a heated argument at his biryani shop in JJ Colony in Sector 7, Dwarka, on Sunday, they said.

According to the police, a PCR call regarding the stabbing of a woman near Kali Mata Mandir in JJ Colony was received at 4:49 pm on September 27 at Palam village police station.

The injured woman was rushed to Indira Gandhi Hospital, where doctors declared her dead, police said. A case of murder has been registered on the statement of an eyewitness. Police said Pradeep is the alleged accused and efforts are underway to apprehend him.

According to preliminary investigation, Pradeep and his wife had been married for around eight years and had two sons, aged five and six. The couple, originally from Bulandshahr in Uttar Pradesh, lived in the Raj Nagar Park area.

Pradeep worked as a drummer and also ran a biryani shop in the JJ Colony area. Police said Pradeep allegedly had a relationship with another woman, which was opposed by his wife. The issue had led to frequent arguments between the couple.

During an argument, Pradeep allegedly stabbed his wife multiple times with a butcher's knife before fleeing. Police teams are conducting raids to arrest him.

MCD carries out 29 demolition actions and seals 10 properties

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 28



The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Monday carried out 29 demolition actions across all 12 zones as part of its ongoing city-wide enforcement drive against unauthorised constructions, dangerous buildings and violations of building norms.

The civic body also sealed 10 properties and issued seven demolition orders during the day-long exercise, according to a statement issued by the MCD. The action was aimed at enforcing provisions of the Master Plan of Delhi (MPD), Building Bye-Laws and other applicable regulations.

The demolition drive covered several parts of the city, including Hari Nagar, Tagore Garden Extension, Vikas Puri, Dabri More, Sitapuri, Regharpura, Dev Nagar, Sharda Puri and Keshavpuram in west and north-west Delhi.

Further action was reported from Kapil Vihar, Shakarpur, Kailash Nagar, Gandhi Nagar, Madhu Vihar, West Vinod Nagar and Old Seemapuri. Teams also carried out demolition-related action in Chauhan Banger, Bamnoli, Kadipur, Keshav Nagar and Ibrahimpur, among other locations.

The MCD said enforcement teams were maintaining vigilance across its jurisdiction to identify violations and initiate action in accordance with prescribed rules. Officials have been directed to continue monitoring construction activity and take necessary measures against violations.

The civic body said the enforcement exercise would continue across all 12 zones, with focus on unauthorised constructions, dangerous structures and other building violations that could pose risks to public safety.

The latest action comes amid the MCD's continued enforcement campaign against building norm violations across the Capital.

'AAP MLA BOOKED FOR OBSTRUCTING OFFICIAL DUTY'

Delhi Police file non-cognisable report for voluntarily causing hurt against PWD min

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28



SINGH WAS RECORDING THE INSPECTION WHEN PARVESH VERMA SLAPPED HIM

Delhi Police has filed a non-cognisable report (NCR) against PWD Minister Parvesh Verma for slapping a 22-year-old man during a road inspection in west Delhi's Tilak Nagar, while an FIR has been registered against AAP MLA Jarnail Singh for allegedly obstructing public servants in the discharge of their duty, officials said on Monday.

The FIR against Singh was registered on the complaint of a PWD assistant engineer, while the NCR against Verma was filed on a complaint by the man, Sahib Singh, under Section 115 of the BNS pertaining to voluntarily causing hurt, they said.

DCP (West) Hareshwar Swami said action under relevant sections of law was taken on the complaints of Sahib Singh and the PWD assistant engineer.

"Some other complaints have also been received regarding the incident, which will be taken up during the course of investigation," Swami said.

The incident took place on Sunday during an inspection of road repair work on a stretch of the Outer Ring Road between the Janakpuri District Centre Chowk and the Najafgarh Drain. A video showing Verma slapping Singh circulated widely on social media.

According to the complaint, Singh was recording the inspection when Verma slapped him.

The incident occurred when Jarnail Singh, who was present at the spot, questioned the quality of a newly laid road surface after pulling out portions of it by hand. Sahib Singh was filming the proceedings when Verma slapped him. Singh later accused the Delhi government of carrying out substandard road work.

Verma, however, said he would not tolerate what he described as attempts by AAP workers to obstruct government officials from carrying out their duties. He also alleged that Singh was associated with the AAP and had a previous case against him.

The Delhi BJP on Sunday had expressed regret over the incident, even as it alleged that Sahib Singh was a habitual offender.

AAP national convenor Arvind Kejriwal urged PM Narendra Modi to arrest Verma and those responsible for alleged corruption in the Tilak Nagar road project. He said such action would connect with Gen Z more than "late night reels" or "bhajan clubbing", alleging Delhi Police had been given "orders from above" to protect the minister.

According to police records, Sahib Singh was an accused in an assault case involving an MCD worker in June this year. He was arrested in the case and subsequently granted bail.

AIMS TO TAKE ARTISTS TO GLOBAL STAGE

Delhi & ICCR pact opens global avenues for artists

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 28



The Delhi government and Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR) on Monday signed an MoU to expand international opportunities for the capital's artists and strengthen cultural and academic exchanges, with a focus on tourism promotion and global outreach.

The agreement, signed in the presence of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, will enable established and emerging Delhi artists to participate in ICCR's Horizon Series and international cultural festivals. The government will identify talent across performing arts, literature, sculpture, textiles, architecture, culinary arts and handicrafts and create a comprehensive directory to be shared with ICCR.

The partnership will facilitate participation of foreign artists in Delhi's cultural and tourism festivals.

Joint exhibitions, artist residency programmes, workshops and seminars involving Indian and international artists will also be organised.

Foreign scholars and dignitaries visiting under ICCR programmes will be hosted in Delhi, while study camps and orientation visits will be arranged for foreign students to showcase the city's historical and cultural heritage.

The MoU will remain valid for five years and can be extended for another five years by mutual consent. A joint committee comprising ICCR and Delhi government officials will prepare an annual activity plan and oversee implementation.

"Along with development, Delhi's rich heritage, art and cultural identity must also move forward equally," Gupta said, adding that the partnership would give fresh momentum to the city's culture, tourism and creative economy.

Art, Culture and Language Minister Kapil Mishra said the agreement would create international opportunities for local talent and strengthen cultural exchanges with foreign artists and scholars.

'New excise policy likely in Oct'

Govt-controlled liquor retail model likely to continue

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 28

Delhi is likely to notify its new excise policy in October, with the proposed framework set to bring changes in liquor retail margins, excise duty and the availability of premium liquor across the capital.

The proposed policy is expected to retain the government-controlled retail model, with no immediate plan to allow private players to enter Delhi's liquor retail sector. The final proposal will be placed before the Delhi Cabinet and Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu for approval after the new officer assumes charge.

The policy is expected to make significant changes to the existing retail structure, including a revision of fixed retail margins and excise duty. The government is also looking at increasing the number of premium liquor outlets in the capital.

Under the existing system, fixed margins have reportedly made it difficult for government-run liquor shops to stock premium imported brands, particularly those priced above Rs.1,000. Officials cited the price difference between Delhi and neighbouring Haryana cities as one of the issues the proposed changes seek to address.

According to the report, a premium whisky brand that may cost around Rs.3,500 in Delhi can be available for about Rs.2,400 in Gurugram, where retailers operate without the same fixed-margin structure.

The proposed changes are intended to improve the viability of premium liquor sales in Delhi and encourage retailers to upgrade their outlets. The policy is expected to be finalised after the appointment of the new excise commissioner and subsequent approvals, ahead of the peak festive season.

KEY POINTS

- The government is also looking at increasing the number of premium liquor outlets in Delhi
- The policy is expected to make significant changes to the existing retail structure, including a revision of fixed retail margins...
- The proposed changes are intended to improve the viability of premium liquor sales in Capital

Pralhad Joshi meets French education minister

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

Union Education Minister Pralhad Joshi met his French counterpart Philippe Baptiste on Monday and discussed expanding student and faculty mobility besides avenues for further strengthening India-France partnership in education, research and innovation.

The French minister is on a three-day visit to India from September 28 to 30. "Engaged with H.E. Mr @PhBaptiste, Minister for Higher Education, Research and Space of France, to further strengthen the India-France partnership in education, research and innovation," Joshi said in a post on X.

"Discussed expanding student and faculty mobility, strengthening institutional partnerships and joint research, advancing the revised Mutual Recognition of Qualifications Agreement, and taking forward collaborations through SPARC, GIAN and the Franco-Indian Campus in Life Sciences & Health.

"Also discussed the proposed IIT campus in Nice and building on the momentum of #BharatInnovates2026," he added.

After the meeting, Joshi said the India-France Year of Innovation 2026 offers a strong platform to deepen partnerships, foster innovation and build future-ready talent through closer academic and research linkages between the two countries.

ODISHA FLOOD

Over 1 lakh affected people evacuated

MPOST BUREAU
Bhubaneswar, September 29



SDRF personnel conduct a rescue operation at a flood-affected area of Surali village in Koraput, Odisha, Sunday pti

The Odisha government has shifted around 1.4 lakh people to safer locations over the past four days, as a fresh wave of flood affected several districts, officials said on Monday.

Revenue and Disaster Management Minister Suresh Pujari said the government has evacuated 1.4 lakh people from low-lying areas across 7,834 villages under 1,360 gram panchayats. In addition, 219 wards in 38 urban local bodies (ULBs) have also been affected.

Officials said river Mahanadi also experienced a "minor flood" that crisscrossed the densely populated coastal districts, after release of excess water from the Hirakud Dam.

Water Resources Department engineer-in-chief Dilip Kumar Rout said a "minor flood" in river Mahanadi takes place when around 8 lakh cusecs of water flows at the Mundali gauge station near Cuttack. "The flow of over 10 lakh cusecs at Mundali is considered a major flood in the Mahanadi," he said.

Rout said the district administrations of Cuttack, Khurda, Puri, Jagatsinghpur and Kendrapara have been alerted, as the swelling water level could inundate several villages in the Mahanadi delta region.

Lakhs of people in the northern districts of Balasore, Bhadrak, Jajpur and Mayurbhanj have already been reeling under the deluge, due to flooding in Subarnarekha, Budhabalang, Jalaka, Baitarani, Salandi and their tributaries, the officials said.

KEY POINTS

- Officials said river Mahanadi also experienced a "minor flood" that crisscrossed the densely populated coastal districts, after release of excess water from the Hirakud Dam
- Lakhs of people in the northern districts of Balasore, Bhadrak, Jajpur and Mayurbhanj have already been reeling under the deluge, due to flooding in Subarnarekha, Budhabalang, Jalaka, Baitarani, Salandi and their tributaries, the officials said

The minister, however, said the government expects the situation to improve within the next 24 hours, as water levels in several rivers have started to recede.

Commenting on the worst-hit Balasore district, Collector Suryawanshi Mayur Vikas said: "Over 3.5 lakh people in 11 blocks have been impacted by the floods in river Subarnarekha, Budhabalang and Jalaka rivers. More than 67,000 people have been evacuated from Bhograi, Jaleswar, Baliapal, Balasore, Remuna, Nilagiri and Sora blocks."

Rout said rivers in northern Odisha, including the Subarnarekha, were flowing below the danger mark.

Though the water level receded in rivers, "about three-foot flood water" was recorded in several villages of Balasore, Bhadrak and Jajpur districts, prompting the state government to intensify relief operations, he said.

"We expect that peak flooding (in the Mahanadi) will take place on Monday night with the water level rising to 8 lakh cusecs at Mundali," Rout said.

He said the flood water is being discharged through 30 sluice gates of the Hirakud Dam.

Pujari said a total of 64 response teams have been deployed in the affected areas.

The minister said the district administrations have been instructed to take immediate action regarding localised flooding, waterlogging on roads, and the closure of urban underpasses if necessary.

UP: Four killed as LPG cylinder explosion brings down 2-storey house

One critical among three injured



A poliec official and people stand on a damaged structure after a domestic LPG cylinder exploded, in Fatehpur district, Monday PTI

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Kanpur, September 28

At least four persons including a four-year-old boy died, while three others sustained injuries, after a domestic LPG cylinder exploded, causing a two-storey building to collapse in Malwan town in Uttar Pradesh's Fatehpur district on Monday evening, police said.

Among the injured, two are out of danger, while another has suffered around 90 per cent burns and is said to be critical.

The blast occurred around 5 pm when meals were being prepared at the residence of Suresh Gupta alias Chunnar, a fruit and vegetable vendor, Superintendent of Police Abhimanyu Manglik told news agency.

The explosion brought down the two-storey building, trapping family members under debris and affecting several nearby houses, the SP said.

Seven people were pulled out from the debris and taken to hospital, he said. Subsequently, four persons -- Kunal Gupta (18), Arpit Gupta (15), Ved Gupta (8) and Yash Gupta (4) -- succumbed to injuries during treatment.

Alok Gupta (25) has sustained severe burn injuries and is critical, police said

The bodies of the deceased have been sent for post-mortem.

Police, fire brigade personnel and local residents joined the rescue operation. The cause of the blast is being investigated, officials said.

Condoling the deaths, Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath in a post on X said, "The loss of lives in a tragic accident in Fatehpur district is extremely heartbreaking. Officials have been directed to immediately reach the site, expedite relief efforts, and communicate with the families of the injured to provide every possible assistance."

In an official statement, the state government said the chief minister has announced financial aid of Rs 2 lakh each for the kin of the deceased, and Rs 50,000 each for the injured.

From page 1

Delhi draws

at authorised parking sites will be doubled until February 28, 2027. DMRC-owned and managed parking facilities will be exempt. MCD offices will function from 8.30 am to 5 pm and Delhi government offices from 10 am to 6.30 pm. Government and private offices will also reduce their in-office workforce by 50 per cent, with half the staff working from home.

Construction restrictions to be phased

Dust-generating demolition and outdoor civil construction activities will be prohibited from November 1, 2026 to January 31, 2027. A complete ban on construction and demolition activities will subsequently remain in force from December 10 to January 20. Of 723 registered construction sites, 600, or 83 per cent, are already under web-camera monitoring, with complete coverage targeted by October 31.

Transport measures strengthened

The government will intensify the "No PUCC-No Fuel" mechanism across 500 fuel stations and strengthen action against end-of-life vehicles through ANPR-based systems. PUCC centres will also be revamped. Three Automated Testing Stations currently have a combined capacity to test 2.44 lakh commercial vehicles annually.Delhi's bus fleet has reached 6,840, including 5,088 electric buses, while last-mile connectivity is available at all 228 Metro stations. The government has set targets of increasing average daily Metro ridership from 65 lakh to 72 lakh and DTC ridership from 37 lakh to 42 lakh. Metro Sarthi, shared mobility and car-pooling will also be promoted.

Dust, open burning and industrial pollution

Delhi has targeted redevelopment of 3,065 km of roads in 2026, compared with an annual average of around 1,000 km. As of September 20, 1,193 km had been completed, leaving 1,872 km under execution, with cement-concrete works targeted for completion by October 31.

Mechanised road-sweeping machines have increased from 76 last year to 98, with double-shift operations. Zero Open Burning teams will operate at ward and district levels, while citizens can report violations through 311 and the Green Delhi App.

Between December 1, 2025 and September 26, 2026, around 11,271 industrial units were surveyed, of which 2,283 were closed or sealed, 1,665 for air pollution and 618 for water pollution.

Monitoring network expanded

The Continuous Ambient Air Quality Monitoring Stations network will expand from 47 to 60 stations. An AI-enabled Command and Control Centre and 334 enforcement teams, 256 ward teams and 78 Delhi Pollution Control Committee teams, will support monitoring, backed by PTZ cameras and geo-tagged, time-stamped inspections.

The government said Delhi has also crossed its target of planting 70 lakh trees, while 433 acres of identified brown areas have been greened.

"Air pollution does not recognise administrative boundaries. Delhi is taking responsibility for every source of pollution within its jurisdiction, but a significant share of the pollution affecting the capital is influenced by the surrounding areas. Delhi will act, Delhi will enforce, but the entire NCR must work together. Clean air is a shared responsibility," Sirsa said. He added, "The Government will act, departments will be accountable, and I will personally monitor implementation on the ground. But the Government alone cannot deliver clean air. Every citizen has a role to play."

SC questions

"Is it a tax or a fee? If not a fee, then what is the executive basis for making this expropriation?" it asked.

Venkataraman rejected the description of the charge as expropriation, saying it was a settlement fee between payment aggregators and banks and that the government was "several steps away from this money". He also told the court that charges for essential services would be capped at Rs 5.

"It is neither a tax nor a fee," he said.

The court said the matter required clarification on the technical and operational aspects of the framework. "We need all these facts in a short affidavit. It will help us understand better. It is less a legal issue and more a technical issue," the bench observed.

The petitioner, advocate Anjan Datta, has challenged the Centre's September 14 notification and the MDR framework announced on September 15. The plea questions the constitutional validity of the amended Section 10A of the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, and alleges that the framework lacks adequate statutory safeguards, transparency and public consultation.

Under the new framework, a 0.4 per cent MDR will apply to specified UPI person-to-merchant payments above Rs 2,000, subject to a maximum of Rs 300 for transactions of Rs 75,000 and above. Essential and thin-margin sectors such as railways, telecom, insurance, fuel and agricultural inputs will face a flat Rs 5 charge per qualifying transaction.

Payments involving mutual funds, securities, stockbrokers and dealers will attract MDR of 0.02 per cent, also capped at Rs 300.

Person-to-person UPI payments will remain free regardless of value. Such transactions account for 37 per cent of UPI's transaction volume and 70 per cent of its transaction value.

The petitioner has also questioned the continued absence of a monetary ceiling on zero-charge RuPay debit card payments and sought reconsideration of the UPI framework after consultation, publication of supporting data and an assessment of its impact on merchants.

Sensex, Nifty

Investors lost another Rs 7.52 lakh crore during the session.

Brent crude surged nearly 4 per cent to USD 108.3 a barrel, adding to concerns over inflation and economic pressures.

SC suggests

"If people are not paying traffic challans, add it to their electricity dues bill. They will have to pay electricity bills else power line will be disconnected. Work it out. In this country, you have to find a way out," the court said.

The bench also proposed blacklisting vehicles with unpaid challans on the Parivahan portal and blocking their ownership transfers. Justice Pardiwala called for enforcement beyond issuing notices, suggesting random checks of vehicles to identify defaulters. The court said vehicles found carrying unpaid e-challans could be impounded and necessary action taken.

The observations came during hearing of a plea seeking systemic reforms in road safety, traffic enforcement and post-accident victim care.

'Systematic failure'

the Constitution. It said public spaces, including parks, roads, buses, metro stations, subways and footbridges, cannot become "zones of high risk" because of inadequate lighting, poor surveillance, lax patrolling or other preventable administrative deficiencies.

The court directed the Delhi Police Commissioner to constitute dedicated police teams in every district, headed by an officer not below the rank of deputy superintendent of police, within four weeks, to conduct an immediate survey and inspection of vulnerable pockets. The audit will use NCRB data, local intelligence, complaints and previous incidents to identify locations where poor lighting, inadequate surveillance, insufficient patrolling, abandoned structures, poor access control or other deficiencies may increase the risk of crime. District-wise vulnerability maps will be prepared and shared with adjoining police stations. The bench directed that appropriate patrolling and security arrangements be deployed at identified public parks and vulnerable areas at all times, particularly during evening and early morning hours. A designated officer will be responsible for each location and periodic inspections will be carried out.

It also ordered an immediate lighting and CCTV audit across public parks and vulnerable zones, with non-functional cameras and lighting infrastructure to be repaired or restored. Additional lights and CCTVs are to be installed wherever deficiencies are identified or reported by citizens. Similar audits will cover metro stations, bus stops, bus terminals, railway stations and other major public transport facilities, particularly those in or adjoining vulnerable zones.

The court directed authorities to use existing citizen grievance mechanisms, including the CM Jan Sunwai Portal, to identify public safety deficiencies. Complaints concerning inadequate lighting, insufficient CCTV coverage, dark or isolated stretches and unsafe access points are to be made location-specific where appropriate, forwarded for verification and acted upon within a prescribed timeframe.

The bench also sought a comprehensive status report on safety arrangements in public places frequented by women and children, including parks, roads, public transport facilities, markets and educational institutions. The report will state whether such arrangements remain effective during peak hours, late evenings and early mornings.

The court further sought details on the use of the National Database on Sexual Offenders by Delhi Police, including whether it is regularly accessed for antecedent verification and identification of repeat or habitual sexual offenders, the number of times it was used in investigations in Delhi during the preceding five years and whether information from the database is being translated into lawful preventive measures.

It also sought details from the Ministry of Home Affairs on the Investigation Tracking System for Sexual Offences, including how investigations are monitored against statutory timelines, the officers responsible, the frequency of reviews, remedial action in delayed cases and whether senior officers receive alerts or periodic reports when prescribed timelines are not followed. The registrar general of the Delhi High Court has been directed to submit within four weeks comprehensive information on the present status and functioning of fast-track special courts and exclusive POCSO courts in Delhi. The concerned authorities must also inform the court about the operation of Mission Shakti in Delhi and the functioning of measures including Emergency Response Support System 112, Women Helpline 181 and the Safe City Project, including the status of CCTV coverage. The bench said, "Expressions of concern, devoid of accountability, fall short of answering the larger institutional question," adding that "what is required is a measurable response" with responsibility and accountability fixed upon the authorities entrusted with public safety.

India approves

bilateral relations on a progressive and concrete track. The move follows a period of tensions, difficulties and lows in the bilateral ties between the two neighbours. The two countries continue to engage on several sensitive issues, including Dhaka's request for the extradition of former Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina, who was ousted and took shelter in India in August 2024. The appointment of the serving Foreign Secretary as the new envoy is also significant, as both countries are working towards strengthening diplomatic engagement and discussing a possible visit by Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman to India. Salahuddin Noman Chowdhury, Bangladesh's former Permanent Representative to the United Nations in New York, is expected to succeed Siam as Foreign Secretary. The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) has said India desires positive, constructive and forward-looking ties with Bangladesh, and New Delhi is ready to discuss with Dhaka all bilateral issues within the existing structured mechanisms. Earlier, the Modi government had appointed former Union Minister and seasoned senior politician Dinesh Trivedi as its new envoy in Dhaka.

Ujjain on boil

before using mild force and tear gas. No injuries were reported. "CCTV cameras have been installed and drone cameras are also monitoring the area. Through these cameras, those involved in the stone-pelting are being identified, and legal action will be taken," Sharma said. Police also conducted flag marches and continued monitoring social media. The incident came as the High Court's Indore bench of Justices Subodh Abhyankar and Jai Kumar Pillai disposed of the appeals after being informed that an agreement had been reached. Lawyer Kuldeep Pathak said the administration had initially sought removal of about 9.5 feet of the mosque, but the agreement provided for around three feet. A minaret would be relocated within the building and alternative shops would be provided for affected ground-floor shops.

The road from Kanthal crossing to Gopal Mandir is being widened to 15 metres over a 900-metre stretch to facilitate movement of pilgrims. The larger project affects 272 structures, including religious sites, with around Rs 9.8 crore sanctioned by the state government.

Collector Roshan Singh said the mosque portion was being removed voluntarily and appealed against rumours. City Qazi Khalil-ur-Rehman also urged people not to gather at the site unnecessarily. On Sunday, Chief Minister Mohan Yadav began removing part of his ancestral house as part of the road-widening drive.

Briefs

Karnataka CM meets Rajnath

NEW DELHI: Karnataka Chief Minister D K Shivakumar on Monday met Defence minister Rajnath Singh and requested that contingents from all three wings of the armed forces take part in tableaux and ceremonial events at the Mysuru Dasara.

He also asked for an air show during this year's festival, scheduled for October 21.

Shivakumar told reporters here that the Centre had responded positively to the requests.

'SP-Congress ki Lanka jalaoge'

LUCKNOW: Uttar Pradesh minister Om Prakash Rajbhar on Monday urged newly appointed gram panchayat officers to publicise the work done by the Yogi government ahead of the 2027 assembly polls and ensure the rout of the Samajwadi Party (SP) and Congress.

He was speaking at a programme in Lucknow where appointment letters were distributed to 1,375 newly selected Gram Panchayat officers.

Jan Suraaj changes MLC poll candidate

PATNA: Prashant Kishor-led Jan Suraaj Party on Monday replaced its candidate for the Darbhanga Graduates' constituency in the upcoming Bihar Legislative Council elections, naming Mohammad Imtiyaz (Noorani) as its new nominee.

The party had earlier fielded nominee Ravindra Yadav for the seat.

TN: Gold-ring scheme launched

MADURAI: Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Monday launched the 22-carat one-gram gold ring scheme - Maternal Uncle Gold Ring Scheme (Thaaimaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam) - for newborn babies, fulfilling a key electoral promise.

Rolling out the scheme at the Government Rajaji hospital here, Vijay held the babies for a while and gave away the gold rings.

Char Dham Yatra resumes

DEHRADUN: The Char Dham Yatra in Uttarakhand has resumed after a two-day suspension due to bad weather, and authorities have issued guidelines to all concerned District Magistrates, a senior official said on Monday.

The pilgrimage was suspended from the afternoon of September 26 until September 27, to ensure the safety of travellers and pilgrims, following the IMD's forecast.

'ISSUE CONCERNS SURVIVAL OF DEMOCRACY'

CEC's ouster: Cong to hold CWC meet today to chalk out strategy

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge has called a meeting of the party's working committee on Tuesday where the issue of "internal differences" in the Election Commission would be discussed and a roadmap for CEC Gyanesh Kumar's removal would be chalked out.

Announcing this, Kharge said that the Election Commissioners have "exposed" the working within the poll body by raising concerns over Special Intensive Revision (SIR) and changes in Form 6 for enrolling new voters, besides additions and deletions from voter lists and centralised control over the electoral roll database.

He said the issue is very serious and concerns the survival of democracy in the country and has to be taken up on priority.

"I have called a Working Committee meeting for tomorrow, where we will discuss the issue and all the Working Committee members will give their suggestions.

"We are going to fight this seriously. This issue concerns the entire country, the existence of our democracy and the survival of our country. That is why we are very serious about this issue," he told reporters.

"The Election Commission's own people have exposed them. Even a former chief secretary of Kerala has said that the CEC himself told him to contest the election. This means that he is propagating the BJP's philosophy and has become a BJP worker," he claimed.

"Gyanesh Kumar should resign. We have to take action against him, even after his resignation," the Congress chief said.

The CWC meeting, chaired by Kharge, is likely to be attended by former party chief Rahul Gandhi, Congress general secretaries Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, Jairam Ramesh, KC Venugopal, among others.

Sources said the party's highest decision-making body will strategise on ramping up pressure over its demand for CEC Kumar's removal and cornering the government on the issue.

They said preparations for the upcoming polls are also likely to be discussed.

The Congress has alleged that Gen Z is being targeted for exclusion during SIR and pressed for its demand that Kumar must resign immediately.

Meanwhile, the Opposition INDIA Bloc would also meet on Wednesday to chalk out a joint strategy on the issue and is likely to file another notice for removal of CEC Kumar in Parliament.

Under fire over the red flags raised by two of its commissioners over the SIR process, the EC has asserted that differing views and observations are a normal part of deliberations in any institution and all its orders carry full legal sanction and follow established statutory procedures.



Congress workers stage a protest against CEC Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the SIR of electoral rolls, in Prayagraj, Monday PTI

KEY POINTS

- Kharge said that the Election Commissioners have "exposed" the working within the poll body by raising concerns over SIR
- The Congress has alleged that Gen Z is being targeted for exclusion during SIR and pressed for its demand that Kumar must resign immediately

J&K Assembly passes statehood resolution amid protests by BJP

On November 6, 2024, the House passed a resolution seeking the restoration of special status

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Srinagar, September 28

The Jammu and Kashmir Legislative Assembly on Monday passed a resolution seeking urgent restoration of full statehood, amid a walkout by the Opposition BJP.

The resolution was moved by Chief Minister Omar Abdullah on Friday last week. However, it was deferred as several members wanted to speak over the issue.

The Opposition BJP protested against the resolution on Friday as well as on Monday, with party members jumping into the well of the House, tearing business papers and conducted mock proceedings.

"In addition to the resolutions passed by this House on 26, June 2000 and 6 November, 2024, the House calls upon the Government of India for the immediate and urgent restoration of full statehood to Jammu and Kashmir and resolves that this resolution be forwarded to the Government of India," the resolution read.

The NC-led government headed by Farooq Abdullah had passed a resolution on June 26, 2000 for restoration of greater autonomy as existed before August 9, 1953.

On November 6, 2024, the House passed a resolution seeking the restoration of special status.



CM Omar Abdullah looks on during a protest by BJP MLAs at autumn session of Assembly, in Srinagar PTI

Several members, including from the ruling National Conference (NC), had moved amendments to the resolution, with many seeking that the resolution also demand the restoration of special status.

However, while responding during the debate, the chief minister urged the members to withdraw their amendments, saying "they had got trapped in this scheme (of the BJP) and moved amendments".

BJP rigged EVMs to harm BSP: Mayawati

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Lucknow, September 28

Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP) chief and former Uttar Pradesh chief minister Mayawati on Monday alleged that the BJP, as part of a conspiracy to harm the BSP, rigged EVMs to ensure election of Chandra Shekhar Aazad from the Nagina Lok Sabha seat.

Addressing a press conference here on Monday, Mayawati alleged the Azad Samaj Party (Kanshi Ram) founder and MP is working at the behest of the BJP.

Wherever there are protests by Dalits, he (Aazad) appears there and provokes them -- eventually leading to police cases against the protestors, who lose out on government jobs because of this, she claimed. Referring to the BSP's traditional voters, she said they vote for the party considering it their only well-wisher, but their votes end up in someone else's account, causing them to lose faith in elections.

She said once a case is registered against these youths, they become ineligible for government jobs until the case is disposed of, and gradually fall behind while having to make rounds of courts.

Sharad Pawar rules out political realignment

Says we are not going anywhere

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, September 28

NCP (SP) chief Sharad Pawar on Monday dismissed speculation of his party going with "those in power", while triggering fresh political chatter about a merger between two NCP factions, saying those interested can join his party.

"We are not going anywhere. We will not go with anyone. If you want to come, come with us," Pawar said without naming any party.

Speaking at a gathering of party workers here, the Opposition stalwart pointed out that there is speculation about the NCP (SP) going with "those in power".

The Nationalist Congress Party (Sharadchandra Pawar) is part of the Maha Vikas Aghadi, which also comprises the Uddhav Thackeray-led Shiv Sena (UBT) and the Congress.

Speculation about unification of NCP (Sharadchandra Pawar) and Deputy CM Sunetra Pawar-led Nationalist Congress Party, which is part of the Mahayuti government, often crops up in state political circles.

NCP (SP) Maharashtra unit president Shashikant Shinde later told reporters that Pawar had cleared the party's stand.

He said Pawar has stated that unification can happen only if the other group (part of the Mahayuti government) merges with NCP (SP).

Addressing the gathering, Pawar said NCP (SP) will take to the streets against the Maharashtra government if its demands for drought relief are not accepted.

"We don't want to fight. We will urge the government. If our demands are not accepted in the next two to four days, we will take to the streets and fight," he said.

Sharp drop in AAP donations in 2025-26

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

The AAP has disclosed Rs 12.10 crore in contributions for 2025-26, down 68 per cent from the previous year, with nearly 83 per cent of the amount coming from Prudent Electoral Trust and Trident Limited, a company founded by former party MP Rajinder Gupta.

Prudent and Trident each gave Rs 5 crore to the AAP, according to the party's report to the Election Commission. The remaining contributions totalled about Rs 2.10 crore.

Gupta was elected to the Rajya Sabha on an AAP ticket in October 2025.

Trident's Rs 5-crore cheque was dated January 9, 2026, when Gupta was with the Arvind Kejriwal-led party. He joined the BJP in April this year.

AAP had disclosed Rs 38.10 crore in contributions in 2024-25, more than three times the Rs 11.06 crore it reported in 2023-24.

Congress turns up heat on CEC

Holds protests across country for his removal

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

The Congress on Monday took to the streets against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, holding protests across the country and burning his effigies amid the SIR row, and said the groundswell against him will only increase till he is removed.

Congress workers protested outside CEC Kumar's residence in Agra and raised slogans while defacing the main gate and a wall of the house with spray paint. They put up stickers and pasted pamphlets outside his Vijay Nagar home and wrote "Gyanesh Gaddar Gyanesh Chor" -- calling the CEC a "traitor" and a "thief" -- in Hindi.

Police used water cannons to disperse the protesters who tried to scale barricades at many places, including Jaipur and Bhopal.

The protests came as Opposition parties, which have been critical of CEC Kumar over the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, called for his immediate removal after it came to light that Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi had recorded objections on at least 14 occasions over a 10-month period to decisions and orders, some of which they said were issued without their knowledge.

Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge said the party will deliberate on further strategy on the issue on Tuesday when its top decision-making body - the Congress Working Committee - will meet here.

The Congress also held protests at several places in Punjab, Haryana, Jammu and Kashmir, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Jharkhand, Bihar, Telangana, Karnataka, Gujarat, Assam, Chhattisgarh, Goa, among others, accusing the CEC of acting in favour of the BJP.



Congress leaders and party members during a protest against the ECI, in Gurugram, Monday PTI

BJP using education and religion to divide people: Akhilesh

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, September 28

Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav on Monday accused the BJP of using issues such as education and religion to divide society, alleging discrimination against madrasas and claiming that the ruling party had failed to strengthen the education system.

Addressing a press conference in Lucknow, Yadav said the BJP's politics was centred on creating divisions rather than addressing people's concerns.

"This government has no other work. It only wants to divide people," Yadav said, alleging that madrasas had been subjected to discrimination under the BJP government.

The former chief minister also attacked the government's education policies, saying the BJP had provided "half-finished jobs and half-finished education" to the youth. He said the Samajwadi Party, if voted to power, would improve the condition of shiksha mitras and ensure that they received recognition and respect as teachers.

Yadav also reiterated his allegations regarding electoral roll irregularities and claimed that votes of Samajwadi Party supporters were deleted in previous elections. Referring to Form 7 applications, which are used for deletion of names from voter lists, he alleged that BJP workers had sought removal of voters' names in large numbers.

He claimed that in Lucknow a single person had submitted applications for deletion of more than 100 votes, despite rules limiting the number of applications that can be filed by an individual.

SP-Cong alliance: United on paper, uneasy on ground

We are fighting on the surface but we are together internally, this is part of our strategy, says Akhilesh

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, September 28

For nearly a week, Samajwadi Party and Congress leaders have been trading barbs over their alliance for the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections, fuelling speculation about a possible split.

SP chief Akhilesh Yadav sought to end the speculation on Sunday, saying, "We are fighting on the surface, but we are together internally. This is part of our strategy."

But if the alliance is intact, why are the two parties still unable to settle seat sharing?

The problem goes beyond the war of words. It reflects competing claims over political space, seats and the leadership of the anti-BJP campaign in Uttar Pradesh.

The latest controversy began with Congress MP Imran Masood. On September 21, he questioned the need for an alliance if the SP was not ready to move ahead. "If there is no alliance, we are going ahead with our own preparations," he said.

SP MP Iqra Hasan hit back, saying only Akhilesh could defeat the BJP in Uttar Pradesh and that the Congress would gain more from an alliance.

Masood escalated the exchange on September 26. "Why don't we contest separately? Are we begging anyone?" he said.

Senior SP leaders Shivpal Yadav and Ram Gopal Yadav said the Congress had little political standing in the state. Congress state president Ajay Rai's statement that his party would strengthen itself in SP strongholds added to the friction.

Political analyst R N Bajpayee said the Congress is seeking a much larger share, while the SP is reluctant to give it more than around 50 seats.

The SP believes it needs to contest a large number of seats to remain the principal challenger to the BJP.

But the SP is also insisting that seat claims be backed by credible candidates.

According to sources, during the July 20 meeting between Akhilesh Yadav and Rahul Gandhi, with Priyanka Gandhi Vadra also present, Akhilesh conveyed that the Congress would have to name candidates along with the seats it wants.

The SP does not want senior Congress leaders to seek multiple seats in their areas of influence and then push preferred candidates.

The 2024 Lok Sabha election has reinforced this concern. Congress contested 17 seats in Uttar Pradesh and won six. In Prayagraj and Sitapur, former SP leaders joined the Congress and won on its tickets.

TAKEAWAYS

- The latest controversy began with Congress MP Imran Masood. On September 21, he questioned the need for an alliance if the SP was not ready to move ahead
- Senior SP leaders Shivpal Yadav and Ram Gopal Yadav said the Congress had little political standing in the state

PROTESTS SNOWBALL INTO POLITICAL SLUGFEST

Day after protests, calm returns to LPU campus; Opposition & AAP trade barbs

MPOST BUREAU
Phagwara, September 28

Calm returned to the Lovely Professional University (LPU) campus here on Monday, a day after violent protests rocked the private varsity with many students heading home following suspension of classes for 10 days, even as the incident triggered a political slugfest between the ruling AAP and Opposition parties.

Punjab DGP Gaurav Yadav visited the university and asserted that vandals would face action as police were conducting a comprehensive scientific and technical investigation into the violence, which erupted over allegations that a woman student was raped on the campus.

The protests snowballed into a political controversy, with the BJP, the Congress and SAD attacking the AAP government over law and order and questioning the police handling of the situation, while demanding an independent probe into the incident.

However, AAP asserted that police handled the situation with restraint and professionalism, while hitting back at the opposition for "politicising" a sensitive matter involving students.

"At a time when the situation involved students and required sensitivity, some opposition leaders appeared more interested in creating controversy than in allowing the situation to be resolved. They seem to be behaving like vultures, waiting for dead bodies, rather than helping to ensure that the situation remains peaceful," said AAP leader Baltej Pannu.

Mobile internet services were suspended in and around LPU on Monday. However, officials in the evening said the services will be resumed.

DGP Yadav, who visited the LPU on the directions of Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann, said police made sustained efforts to facilitate dialogue between students and the university authorities for an amicable resolution of their grievances.

The LPU authorities held a meeting with the police, civil administration and students' representatives, reiterating that outsiders were to be blamed for the unrest.

The authorities also said the campus was safe, with normal activities resuming.

Earlier, traffic movement on National Highway-44, which had been blocked by the protesting students from the LPU for over 15 hours, was restored, the police said.

A heavy police deployment remained at the university, located along the Jalandhar-Phagwara highway, as students carrying bags and suitcases were seen leaving the campus. Anxious parents also arrived to take their children home.

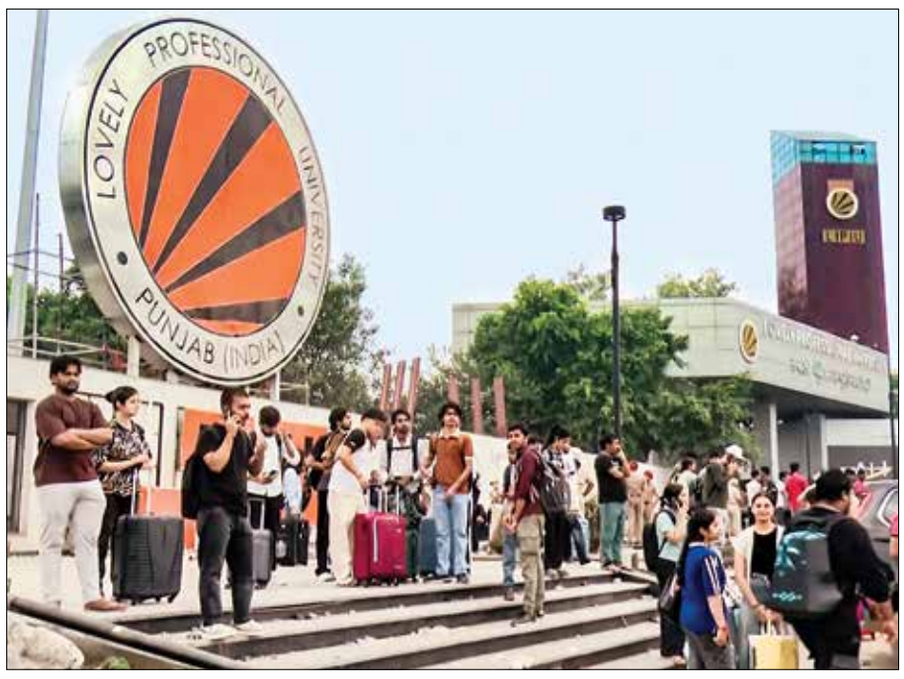
The campus bore signs of violence, with property damaged at several places, while many students blamed outsiders for the vandalism.

On Sunday, LPU students allegedly went on a rampage vandalising property and blocking a stretch of the New Delhi-Amritsar highway outside their campus over claims that an outsider had raped a female student on the university premises.

Later that evening, the protesting students allegedly pelted police personnel with stones and attacked their vehicles, leaving several cops injured, officials said.

In a related development, the Punjab State Women Commission took suo motu cognisance of two protest incidents at LPU and Chitkara University that took place over claims about an alleged rape of a student by an outsider and two girl students' suicide, respectively.

The panel sought detailed reports, including copies of the FIRs and safety measures for students on the campuses from the respective district and police administrations.



LPU students carrying their luggage prepare to leave for their hometowns outside the university campus, in Phagwara, Punjab, Monday PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- Punjab DGP Gaurav Yadav visited the university and asserted that vandals would face action
- AAP asserted that police handled the situation with restraint and professionalism
- It hits back at the Opposition for 'politicising' a sensitive matter involving students

HM Shah calls for strengthening 'counter-terrorism' mechanisms

Extradition Portal launched to boost efforts to bring back fugitives

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Monday called for strengthening India's counter-terrorism mechanisms over the next decade, stressing the need to adopt a proactive, coordinated and result-oriented approach, extending from the national level to individual police stations.

Addressing a conference on 'PRAHAAR – CT Policy and Strategy' in New Delhi, Shah said the country's zero-tolerance policy towards terrorism needed to be backed by continuous analysis of terror incidents and stronger institutional mechanisms for an automated counter-terrorism response network.

The PRAHAAR framework is based on seven pillars -- Prevention, Response, Aggregating Internal Capacities, Human Rights, Attenuating Conditions for Terrorism, Aligning International Efforts, and Recovery and Resilience.

"We have adopted a policy of zero tolerance towards terrorism and it is critical to conduct a continuous analysis of terror incidents to take the PRAHAAR strategy forward," Shah said, stressing that its guiding principles should reach the police-station level.

He also called for closer coordination among security and investigative agencies to ensure there was no delay in responding to terrorism-related threats.



Union HM Amit Shah addresses a conference on 'PRAHAAR – CT Policy and Strategy' in New Delhi

HE ALSO CALLED FOR CLOSER COORDINATION AMONG SECURITY AND INVESTIGATIVE AGENCIES

The conference was attended by the Union Home Secretary, Foreign Secretary, chiefs of Central Armed Police Forces and Central Police Organisations, DGPs of 15 states and heads of Anti-Terrorism Squads of all states and Union Territories. Senior police officers participated virtually.

Shah said enhanced inter-agency coordination had helped dismantle more than 40 modules linked to the Shahzad Bhatti network, which authorities allege was involved in cross-border smuggling of weapons, explosives and narcotics. More than 100 FIRs were registered and 350 people arrested across 15 states, he said.

Pb: Power disconnections put on hold

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 28

The Punjab State Power Corporation Limited (PSPCL) has directed its field offices to keep disconnections of domestic supply (DS) electricity connections for default in abeyance, providing relief to consumers who have received incorrect or inflated bills amid ongoing billing-system issues.

The decision follows complaints from consumers whose bills were generated on an average or presumptive basis and subsequently reflected as outstanding dues in the system.

According to an order issued by PSPCL's Director (Distribution), the recent strike by meter readers and the ongoing migration from SAP/non-SAP systems to the Oracle-based Smart Billing System (SBS) have contributed to billing discrepancies.

As a result, some consumers received bills that did not match their actual electricity consumption, making their connections liable for disconnection over dues arising from incorrect bills.

PSPCL has directed that no disconnection action be taken in such cases until the SBS is stabilised and erroneous or inflated bills are corrected.

Briefs

Namo Cricket League finale inaugurated

CHANDIGARH: Haryana CM Nayab Saini on Monday inaugurated the Grand Finale of the Namo Cricket League-2026 at Panchkula's Tau Devi Lal Sports Complex, marking a vibrant celebration of youth, sportsmanship and the resolve to build a drug-free India. The CM also paid tributes to Shaheed Bhagat Singh, commemorating his birth anniversary.

DHR bags int'l recognition

MALIGAON: The Darjeeling Himalayan Railway (DHR), the iconic heritage railway of Northeast Frontier Railway, has received another significant international recognition with Darjeeling being featured among the 50 destinations in Lonely Planet's prestigious Best in Travel 2027 list. Lonely Planet has described Darjeeling as "Best for a Toy Train journey".

Guj: Three killed in road mishap

ANAND: Three persons were killed and as many others were seriously injured after two motorcycles collided in Gujarat's Anand district. The accident occurred late Sunday night on the Anand-Borsad road when two motorcycles, each carrying three persons, collided head-on, officials said.

Saini calls for transparent delivery of govt schemes

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 28

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Monday directed officials to ensure that government schemes reach eligible beneficiaries transparently and deliver measurable benefits at the grassroots, particularly to farmers, women, youth and rural communities.

Chairing a review meeting in Chandigarh, Saini said departmental best practices should not be judged merely by numbers but by their actual impact on people. He reviewed initiatives of the agriculture, horticulture, irrigation, panchayats and cooperation departments.

The Agriculture Department informed him that linking the Integrated Fertiliser Management System with the Meri Fasal Mera Byora portal had helped curb black marketing and misuse of urea and DAP. The system recorded subsidy savings of Rs 820 crore between October 8, 2025 and September 14, 2026.

DEPARTMENTAL BEST PRACTICES SHOULD BE JUDGED BY THEIR ACTUAL IMPACT ON PEOPLE, THE HARYANA CM SAID

Saini directed agricultural scientists to regularly visit fields and study crop pest and disease outbreaks. He ordered development of an e-Pest Surveillance System and a dedicated research centre for improved crop varieties and technologies.

Reviewing the Bhavantar Bharpai Yojana, he sought stronger crop mapping and verification to ensure benefits go only to eligible farmers. He also directed effective implementation of insurance schemes to ensure compensation for genuine losses.

India hosts 11th AGM of ARIN-AP in New Delhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

India on Monday hosted the 11th Annual General Meeting of the Asset Recovery Interagency Network-Asia Pacific (ARIN-AP) in New Delhi, focusing on stronger international cooperation to trace and recover proceeds of crime.

The four-day meeting, hosted by the Enforcement Directorate as ARIN-AP's 2026 president, will continue till October 1. A Steering Group meeting was held ahead of the AGM. The ED Director stressed cooperation across the asset-recovery process, from tracing and preservation to confiscation, management and restitution.

The meeting will discuss challenges including cyber fraud, online betting, virtual assets, illicit financial flows and outward remittances.

Congress workers deface CEC Kumar's ancestral home in Agra

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, September 28

Congress workers protesting against alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls on Monday smeared black paint on the gate and wall of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's ancestral residence in Agra, escalating the party's statewide agitation seeking his resignation.

The protesters also spray-painted slogans describing Kumar as a "traitor" and "vote thief" at the Vijay Nagar residence. Hundreds of Congress workers gathered there under the leadership of district president Mukesh Dhangar and state organisation general secretary Anil Yadav.

Police subsequently registered a case and began identifying those involved using CCTV footage. Officials said Yadav and Dhangar were arrested while allegedly attempting to leave for Delhi.

In Lucknow, Congress workers trying to march towards the Election Commission office clashed with police after being stopped by barricades. Several were detained and taken to Eco Garden.

In Varanasi, protesters hit a poster of Kumar with shoes, while women workers carried bangles during the demonstration. Protests and scuffles were also reported in Moradabad, Gorakhpur and Saharanpur. In Ghaziabad, Congress leaders staged a sit-in outside the collectorate, while around 50 workers were detained in Hapur.

Hooda: 'CEC helped BJP in manipulating poll process'

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 28



Congress workers staged protests across Haryana on Monday, alleging "vote theft" and collusion between the Election Commission and the BJP, with former chief minister Bhupinder Singh Hooda joining the demonstration in Rohtak.

Hooda accused Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar of helping the BJP manipulate the electoral process and demanded his resignation and arrest, along with a review of election-related decisions taken during his tenure.

He alleged that the Haryana election mandate was "stolen" and said the Congress had raised several questions with the Election Commission but received no answers.

Homebuyer 'fraud' case: Chargesheet filed against 5

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, September 28

The CBI has filed chargesheet against five former promoters and directors of Acme Realties Private Limited and its holding company Acme Housing India Private Limited in an alleged homebuyers' cheating case linked to the "Acme Boulevard" project in Mumbai.

The chargesheet was filed before the ACJM (CBI Cases), 3rd Court, Esplanade Court, Mumbai, in connection with alleged fraudulent practices involving property at Majas village, Sarvodaya Nagar, Jogeshwari (East).

According to the CBI, its investigation found that the accused builder company and its promoters and directors allegedly induced homebuyers to invest by making misleading representations and subsequently obtained financial benefits through unlawful means.

The agency said it had gathered substantial evidence during the investigation and charged the accused under various provisions of the Indian Penal Code relating to criminal conspiracy, cheating, criminal breach of trust and dishonest receipt of stolen property.

The case is part of a larger CBI investigation into alleged cheating of homebuyers and diversion of funds involving builder companies and financial institutions.

The agency is currently probing 32 cases registered following Supreme Court directions against various builders and unidentified officials of financial institutions across the country.

WHO-UNICEF JMP REPORT

In India, 50 mn children lack sanitation in schools

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 28

Nearly a fifth of the children with no access to sanitation services in schools are in India, the highest for any country in the world, according to the WHO-UNICEF Joint Monitoring Programme (JMP) report.

India has 50 million of the world's 244 million children who did not have sanitation services in schools in 2025, the report "Progress on Drinking Water, Sanitation and Hygiene in Schools 2015-2025" noted.

The report also added that India recorded a 14 per cent reduction in the number of schools with no sanitation service during the period assessed.



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

KEY POINTS

- 'Nearly a fifth of the children with no access to sanitation services in schools are in India, the highest for any country in the world'
- The report also added that India recorded a 14% reduction in the number of schools with no sanitation service during the period assessed

The World Health Organization (WHO) and the United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF)'s joint monitoring programme produces internationally comparable estimates of progress on drinking water, sanitation and hygiene (WASH) and is responsible for global monitoring of the Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) targets related to WASH.

The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development includes global goals for water and sanitation and for education. Goal 4 aims to ensure "inclusive and quality education for all and promote lifelong learning" and includes targets to build and upgrade education facilities that are child-, disability- and gender-sensitive and provide safe and effective learning environments for all.

This includes providing all schools with access to electricity, computers, the internet, adapted infrastructure and materials for students with disabilities, and basic WASH services.

Goal 6 aims to "ensure availability and sustainable management of water and sanitation for all" and includes targets for universal access to safe drinking water, sanitation and hygiene for all.

"In 2025, despite progress, 244 million children still had no sanitation service at their school," the report said.

India accounted for 50 million of them, Nigeria 34 million, Ethiopia 26 million, the Democratic Republic of the Congo 11 million and Indonesia 8 million, the report said.

For the purposes of SDG monitoring, a basic drinking water service means schools have access to a functioning improved water source. A basic sanitation service means schools have improved sanitation facilities that are single-sex and usable, and a basic hygiene service means schools have handwashing facilities with soap and water available at the time of the survey.

EDITORIAL

Before Delhi starts choking

Delhi's decision to put several anti-pollution restrictions in place before its air turns hazardous marks a welcome departure from the ritual that has defined the Capital's winters. Every year, pollution rises, emergency measures follow, schools and construction sites are disrupted, and normality returns once the skies clear. This time, the government intends to act earlier. But anticipation, while preferable to panic, cannot substitute for the harder task of reducing pollution year-round.

The winter framework is unusually expansive. From November, parking charges at authorised sites will double, offices will move towards 50 per cent physical attendance, government office timings will be staggered and restrictions will apply to non-BS-VI vehicles registered outside Delhi. Dust-generating construction and demolition will face curbs, including a complete shutdown during the most vulnerable winter weeks. The government has also made a valid Pollution Under Control Certificate necessary for purchasing fuel throughout the year. These measures acknowledge something Delhi has learnt painfully: waiting for the Air Quality Index to cross dangerous thresholds before intervening leaves too little room for prevention.

There is, however, a contradiction at the heart of the approach. Delhi's pollution becomes most visible in winter, but its sources do not disappear in March. Vehicles continue to crowd roads, construction continues to generate dust, waste is still burnt, industrial emissions persist and inadequate last-mile connectivity keeps commuters dependent on private vehicles. Winter merely creates meteorological conditions that trap these pollutants closer to the ground. A four-month emergency regime therefore attacks the period of accumulation more aggressively than the underlying sources.

Nor can Delhi clean its air by acting within its administrative borders. Pollution moves freely across Delhi, Gurugram, Noida, Ghaziabad, Faridabad and the wider National Capital Region. Different enforcement standards across this shared airshed weaken even well-designed measures. The Commission for Air Quality Management was created precisely because the problem demands regional coordination. It must increasingly become an institution of continuous prevention rather than primarily the authority associated with escalating GRAP restrictions.

There are economic costs too. Construction bans hit daily-wage workers before they hurt developers, while work-from-home rules are unavailable to millions whose livelihoods require physical presence. Restrictions must therefore be accompanied by stronger enforcement at source, better dust-management systems and protection for workers who bear the cost of environmental failures they did little to create.

Delhi's new framework gets one important principle right: pollution control must begin before an emergency. The next step is to abandon the idea of a pollution "season" altogether. Cleaner buses, dependable public transport, mechanised road cleaning, strict industrial standards, scientific waste management and coordinated NCR enforcement require attention in May as much as November. Delhi should not have to reorganise life every winter simply to breathe. The real measure of success will be when extraordinary restrictions are no longer necessary because ordinary governance has made the air cleaner.

LETTER

letter2editor.mp@gmail.com.

Public Conduct

The alleged slapping incident involving Delhi minister Parvesh Verma is disturbing. Whatever the provocation, elected representatives must exercise restraint during public confrontations. The police report should be followed by a fair examination of the incident. Political disagreements over civic works cannot become excuses for intimidation or physical aggression in public life.

ANANYA SHARMA,
NOIDA

You can also send your comments to The Editor, *Millennium Post*, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Old Statecraft, New Geopolitics

India's economic resurgence has revived an older tradition of strategic flexibility, diversified partnerships and prosperity built through exchange rather than dependence

BHARAT KI SOCH



RK PACHNANDA

THE WRITER IS THE FORMER CHAIRMAN, HPSC AND DIRECTOR, BHARAT KI SOCH



Shared prosperity remains central to India's expanding engagement with world

India has, since ancient times, held a central place in the world's commercial geography. The economic historian Angus Maddison put the scale plainly: India's share of world GDP was roughly 32 per cent around 1 CE and even in 1700 it stood at 24.4 per cent. This was a country that helped shape how the world traded and grew prosperous as its partners did.

The evidence sits along every coast. In the west, Gujarat and the Malabar coast are linked to Hormuz, Aden and the Red Sea and on to eastern Africa and the Mediterranean. In the east, Indian goods moved through Sri Lanka and the Bay of Bengal to Southeast Asia and China, with Malacca growing into a great entrepôt. India stood between the two halves of that ocean and played every role at once: producer, consumer, intermediary and entrepôt.

Then came the rupture. Two centuries of British rule drained the country's resources and by Independence India's share of world GDP had collapsed to 4.2 per cent. That figure marks the difference between a prosperity built on exchange and a wealth taken by domination. The first lifts others; the second hollows them out.

The last decade tells a story of economic resurgence. Growing at 7.8 per cent, India is the fastest-growing major economy, called by the IMF the "only bright spot in the otherwise dark horizon". It has widened partnerships with the United States, the European Union, the United Kingdom, Japan, Australia and Southeast Asia, deepened engagement with the Gulf and Africa and preserved its ties with Russia. This is strategic maturity: expanding trade agreements and diversifying markets while safeguarding national interests and advancing the vision of Viksit Bharat.

Underneath lies a shift in what strategic autonomy means. Once it meant the freedom to keep one's own course; today that freedom rests as much on economic choices as diplomatic ones. The real objective has become strategic interdependence: relationships diverse enough that dependence on any single country or system never hardens into vulnerability. As globalisation fragments into rival blocs, India's geography suits the task of connecting economies that would otherwise drift apart.

This instinct is not new. India's approaches converge with the Shadgunya of Kautilya's Arthashastra, the six-fold policy a state selects by circumstance: sandhi (peace), vigraha (hostility), asana (watchful neutrality), yana (readiness), samshraya (seeking support) and dvaidhibhava (peace with one power while resisting another). Never a moral code but a flexible one, it aimed at yogakshema, the welfare and security of the realm. India's spread of partnerships across rival camps, its distance from others' disputes and its refusal of permanent blocs are that ancient toolkit in a modern idiom.

BHARAT HAS DRAWN ON CIVILISATIONAL IDEAS TO PURSUE SOVEREIGNTY, INTERDEPENDENCE AND SHARED PROSPERITY

Last week offered a clear demonstration. India's 2026 presidency of BRICS closed with the eighteenth summit in New Delhi, where all eleven members adopted the New Delhi Declaration by consensus despite sharp differences, from tensions between Iran and the UAE to the war in Ukraine. The declaration set a development-oriented, people-centred course and a stronger voice for developing countries. It was the instinct India showed at its own G-20 consensus among nations that rarely agree and the core of its leadership of the Global South.

What is all this ultimately for? Geopolitics and geoeconomics are, at root, geo-centric: arguments about territory, routes and markets. Yet geography matters only because of the people within it. Sea lanes carry food, fuel and medicine; ports raise the towns around them. India treats these as instruments of human welfare, not ends in themselves. Much statecraft measures success in leverage gained; India measures it in lives improved, the difference between a prosperity that circulates and a power that merely accumulates. The measure is one Kautilya set down two millennia ago:

प्रजासुखे सुखं राज्ञः प्रजानां च हिते हितम्।
नात्मप्रियं हितं राज्ञः प्रजानां तु प्रियं हितम्।।

"In the happiness of his subjects lies the king's happiness; in their welfare, his welfare. What pleases the king is not his good - his good is what pleases his people."
(Kautilya's Arthashastra 1.19.34)

Closer to home, the Neighbourhood First policy favours friendly neighbours. The deeper root is civilisational: Bharat's past is bound up with its neighbours, forged over centuries of commerce, migration and cultural exchange across the Indic world. Should those neighbours align around a joint endeavour in consonance with India's growth success, in the spirit of Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam, that all the world is one family, the entire region can prosper by weaving its story with Bharat's story.

None of this is merely aspirational; the instruments already exist. Maitri, the principle of friendship, shaped Vaccine Maitri in the pandemic and India's role as first responder in regional disasters. Project Mausam (2014) seeks to reconnect the Indian Ocean world through its monsoon routes and heritage. The maritime vision has grown from SAGAR (Security and Growth for All in the Region, 2015) to MAHASAGAR (2025), carrying that commitment to the wider Global South. One idea, in several forms: a rising India rises most surely when it helps others rise with it.

Where Kautilya bent statecraft toward the yogakshema of his own realm, India's civilisational instinct widens the frame to all, echoing the old benediction that asks not for the prosperity of one people but of every living being:

सर्वे भवन्तु सुखिनः सर्वे सन्तु निरामयाः।
सर्वे भद्राणि पश्यन्तु मा कश्चिद्दुःखभाग्भवेत्।।

"May all be prosperous and happy, may all be free from illness, may all see what is good; may no one come to suffer."

That foundational vision is now tested against harsh geopolitical realities: sharpening rivalries, energy volatility, economic sanctions and volatile borders. Bharat's response, however, is neither retreat into self-sufficiency nor submission to a single power bloc. Instead, it systematically expands its network of dependable partners, ensuring no single point of pressure becomes a stranglehold. This balance of sovereignty and alignment - sovereign yet engaged, diverse yet harmonious - reflects a statecraft refined over two millennia. This is the very essence of India's modern global posture: a Vishwa Bandhu Bharat.

Views expressed are personal

Defence Promises and Reality

Houthi advances had exposed uncertainties over how the Makkah Pact would respond militarily

SECURITY COMPASS



SHANTANU MUKHARJI

THE WRITER IS A RETIRED IPS OFFICER, ADVISER NATSTRAT

The much hyped and over-publicised Makkah Trilateral Defence Pact signed recently by Saudi Arabia, Pakistan and Turkiye seems to be struggling to find its feet as its first test on the ground failed to take off amid fresh Houthi territorial gains in Mocha, causing a severe setback to Yemen and Saudi Arabia. Pakistan is believed not to have acceded to the Saudi request for military intervention to aid it.

Also, on its part, the US offered intelligence rather than military aid when Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman sought military assistance from President Donald Trump on September 10 to help fight Yemen's Iran-aligned Houthis, amid reports of the Houthis stepping up their threat to the Red Sea. Trump held at least two phone conversations with the Saudi leader but did not agree to the US striking the Houthis, according to a *Reuters* report. Therefore, the latest defence pact, as of now, looks to be under immense strain.

Meanwhile, Riaz Khokhar, a Research Officer with the Institute of Regional Studies (IRS), Islamabad, has articulated his professional views in an opinion piece in Al Jazeera. The repeated attacks against Saudi energy, civil and defence facilities, combined with the maritime blockade by Iran and the Houthis, also directly raise the question of the Makkah Pact's operationalisation between the three signatories. According to him, the three countries have since established a joint secretariat, with its headquarters in Riyadh, with Pakistan taking the chairmanship for an initial three-year term.

The pact now remains in a gestation period. It does not publicly identify the thresholds or scenarios under which a member would move to direct military intervention. Its organisational and institutional structure, including rules of engagement, mechanisms of consultation, and collective defence and deterrence, are yet to be formally developed. Reverting to the question of how the pact will be operational if a member state is attacked, Pakistan's Defence Minister Khawaja Asif said earlier this week that an unprovoked aggression against Saudi Arabia, or a spillover of the Yemen conflict into the kingdom, would make the Makkah Joint Defence Agreement operational. Asif, however, did not share specific details on what shape that operationalisation would take. Last month, Turkiye's Foreign Minister Hakan Fidan clarified that the Makkah Pact would work the same way as NATO: if a member state is attacked, it must actively request and define the specific type of help it needs.



The Makkah Pact faces the difficult transition from promise to practice

A DIRECT MILITARY OPERATION BY PAKISTANI FORCES INSIDE YEMEN REMAINS UNLIKELY

In the meantime, diplomatic efforts have intensified, with Pakistani Field Marshal Asim Munir and Saudi Foreign Minister Prince Faisal bin Farhan Al Saud talking to Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi. Islamabad has also publicly urged Iran to rein in the Houthis from attacking Saudi Arabia and threatening the Bab al-Mandeb, and has reminded Tehran of Pakistan's commitment to Riyadh's defence through the pact. Ankara would likely play its own part in diplomatically restraining the Houthis and Iran. If diplomacy fails and Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia or the Bab al-Mandeb continue, Turkiye and Pakistan may expand the air and technological support they already provide. Islamabad already has an air squadron of about 16 JF-17 Thunder multirole aircraft, defence systems and thousands of troops deployed in Saudi Arabia.

But a direct military operation by Pakistani forces inside Yemen, as per the assessment of Riaz Khokhar, remains unlikely at this moment. Pakistan would be wary of joining a war against Iran and its allies, given the risks to domestic security, sectarian stability and its western border provinces. Building domestic consensus for direct attacks on the Houthis or confrontation with Iran would also be difficult.

The likely scenario, therefore, is that Pakistan would increase joint diplomatic pressure on Iran to restrain the Houthis, further augment its support for Saudi defence and push for a multinational naval coalition to secure the Bab al-Mandeb. Such restraint could preserve the essence of the Makkah Pact while supporting regional de-escalation. The security architecture it envisages will take time to mature. Until mechanisms for collective response are established, direct Pakistani military intervention remains remote, limiting the pact's effectiveness on the ground.

It is also pertinent to mention that Pakistan is thought to have ruled out any further expansion of the Makkah Pact, principally in terms of inducting a new signatory. Bangladesh, in this context, may have to wait in case it is aspiring to join the deal.

Views expressed are personal

News at a glance

Airstrike in Myanmar's Rakhine state kills 33

BANGKOK: An airstrike carried out by Myanmar's military near a market in territory controlled by a powerful rebel group killed at least 33 people and wounded 36 others on Monday, the group and a rescue official said.

The attack in western Rakhine state was the latest in a series of deadly airstrikes against pro-democracy resistance forces and ethnic armed groups across the country. Myanmar has been in turmoil since the military seized power from the elected government of Aung San Suu Kyi.

NK mines likely behind blasts that injured 3 South Korean

SEOUL: North Korea likely planted the land mines that exploded and injured three South Korean soldiers at the country's heavily-armed border last week, South Korea's military said Monday, a finding that could further inflame tensions between the rivals.

The South's Joint Chiefs of Staff announced the preliminary finding after inspecting the site with the US-led United Nations Command. Relations between the Koreas have deteriorated sharply in recent years.



People hold candles as they attend a prayer of the Holy Rosary at Shrine of Our Lady of Lourdes AP/PTI

EU applies for observer status in Saudi Arabia's mission

BRUSSELS: The EU is applying for "observer status" in a new multinational maritime defence coalition led by Saudi Arabia and formed to protect the kingdom's energy exports.

The bloc's top diplomat Kaja Kallas made the announcement on Monday. Kallas said she will ask the assembled ministers to expand the bloc's own small naval force in the Red Sea dubbed ASPIDES to help escort cargo vessels through the key strategic chokepoint of the Bab el-Mandeb strait against attacks by Yemen's Iran-backed Houthi rebels.

Briefs

Pope Leo wraps up France trip

METZ: Pope Leo XIV urged Europe on Monday to draw from its Christian roots and tradition of dialogue to blunt the "desire for domination" driving today's wars, as he wrapped up a visit to France by recalling the forces that contributed to the continent's peaceful integration.

Leo travelled to the eastern city of Metz, near the border with Luxembourg and Germany, to honour Robert Schuman, a French Catholic statesman regarded as one of the founding fathers of European unity after World War II.

Leo decided to end his four-day visit to France in Metz, at a conference centre named for Schuman.

WHO: More people killed in Yemen

GENEVA: The World Health Organisation said it has documented 164 deaths and 645 injuries from the war in Yemen between Sept 19 and Sept 26.

This brings the overall casualties since Aug 6 to 4,481, with 838 fatalities. The latest intense fighting between the Iran-backed Houthis and Yemeni government forces has displaced more than 180,000 people.

Earlier this month, the Houthis stormed down Yemen's coast and seized the crucial port city of Mokha and key Red Sea islands, acquiring higher ground from where they can monitor ships in the Bab el-Mandeb Strait, through which about 12% of the world's trade usually passes.

MASSIVE PORTION OF A MOUNTAIN CRASHED INTO RIVER

Nepal landslides bury homes in Baglung, at least 10 killed

AGENCIES
Kathmandu, September 28

At least 10 people have died after landslides triggered by continuous rainfall buried houses in Nepal's Baglung district, according to several reports.

Several visuals circulating on social media show the terrifying scale of the landslides near Baglung, with huge sections of mountainsides appearing to collapse within seconds.

In one video, a massive portion of a mountain can be seen breaking away and crashing into a river.

The landslides occurred on the 10th and 11th of Asoj across Tamankhola, Nisikhola and Tarakhola rural municipalities, with houses and infrastructure also damaged in several locations.

Meanwhile, at least 21 people have been killed in floods, landslides and other rain-related incidents across Nepal over the past few days, officials said on Sunday.

This comes as relentless rainfall triggered fresh flooding, swept away houses and disrupted road traffic in several parts of the country. The Himalayan nation is still reeling from last month's devastating flash floods.



People watch a collapsed house after a landslide in Lalitpur on Monday AP/PTI

THE HIMALAYAN NATION IS STILL REELING FROM LAST MONTH'S DEVASTATING FLASH FLOODS

Officials say mediators still working with Iran, US on possible deal

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Cairo, September 28

Three officials tell The Associated Press that mediators were still working with Iran and the United States on a deal to end the fighting and open the Strait of Hormuz, with the indirect talks expected to resume on Monday.

The details were revealed as the war enters its eighth month after causing widespread economic suffering. There was uncertainty over the weekend after President Donald Trump told journalists he had rejected Tehran's latest proposal to reopen the strait in a week if the US lifts its blockade of Iranian ports, releases frozen Iranian assets and waives sanctions on Iranian oil sales, among other conditions.

Iran's foreign minister, however, remained in New York and said he awaited word from mediators. Qatar has been mediating.

HIGHLIGHTS

- The US-Iran war has entered in its eighth month
- Iran's foreign minister, remained in New York and said he awaited word from mediators
- That deal seeks to temporarily manage shipping traffic in Strait

Two of the officials speaking to the AP on Monday confirmed that mediators are working with both sides on a proposal that would include reopening the strait and lifting the US blockade, and then removing sanctions.

According to the draft text being discussed, the strait would reopen in accordance with a separate deal that Iran has been discussing with Oman, on the other side of the strait, and it would include no tolls – something Tehran has pursued.

Khamenei says Iranian troops defended Hormuz from 'enemy'

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Dubai, September 28

Iran's supreme leader Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei praised his country's fighters for what he described as preventing "enemy forces" from "roaming freely" in the Strait of Hormuz.

Khamenei said in a message carried by the state broadcaster on Monday that Iran's enemies now "do not come" closer to the strait than the Arabian Sea, which is part of the Indian Ocean.

Soon, "the Arabian Sea too, will be rid of them," said the message, issued to mark the two-year anniversary of the killing of the militant Hezbollah group's longtime leader Hassan Nasrallah in Lebanon.

Khamenei hasn't been seen or heard publicly since the opening attacks of the war on Feb 28 that killed his father and previous supreme leader, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei.

Israel reprimands Spain over youth minister's controversial remarks

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Jerusalem, September 28

Israel summoned the Spanish Embassy's charge d'affaires over remarks by Spain's youth minister who declared the country's public support for a Palestinian state "from the river to the sea" - a slogan that implies a call for the elimination of the Israeli state.

The Israeli Foreign Ministry said Monday that Spanish Youth Minister Sira Rego's remarks were "part of a systematic anti-Israel policy pursued by the Spanish government" and its leader, Prime Minister Pedro Sanchez.

The ministry said Rego had opted not to condemn attacks on Israel.

French presidential campaign heats up as student protests fuel political clashes

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Paris, September 28

French Prime Minister Sebastien Lecornu clashed with far-left leader Jean-Luc Melenchon on Monday over the actions of high school students who are blockading classes and pushing for a nationwide spread of their fledgling protest movement for more resources.

The exchanges in posts on social media between Lecornu and Melenchon, a top presidential contender, reflected the increasingly combative political climate ahead of a crucial presidential election next spring and amid mounting pressure over France's finances.

Politicians across the ideological spectrum are seeking issues that resonate with voters. Complaints from students about deteriorating schools, teacher shortages and heavy class schedules have become the latest cause embraced by some presidential hopefuls.

Lecornu, meanwhile, is trying to build enough public and political support to pass a 2027 state budget through a divided parliament, where President Emmanuel Macron's government is besieged by opponents, many of whom are unwilling to accept proposed spending cuts while soaring energy costs and other expenses squeeze households.

Melenchon, 75, a veteran anti-capitalist firebrand, finished third in the 2022 presidential election and fourth in both 2017 and 2012. The former senator hopes to advance beyond the first round of voting on April 18 and qualify for the May 2 run-off. Younger voters could be key for his chances. Macron is constitutionally barred from seeking a third consecutive term. Melenchon defended the school protesters on Monday after Lecornu accused officials from his far-left France Unbowed party of encouraging the scattered demonstrations.

The protests erupted at schools in the Paris area last week, leading to arrests, and spread to other regions. In the southern Alpes-Maritimes region, police arrested 10 high school students on Monday on allegations of setting fires, throwing projectiles and committing other violent acts that injured two students, the regional government said.

Melenchon accused Lecornu's government of repressing students with "ferocity" and "an unmistakably racist undertone."

HIGHLIGHTS

- Politicians across the ideological spectrum are seeking issues that resonate with voters
- The former senator hopes to advance beyond the first round of voting on April 18 and qualify for the May 2 run-off

Russian drones attack in Ukraine, killing 7



ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kyiv, September 28

Russia's round-the-clock bombardment of targets in Ukraine killed at least seven people and wounded more than 50 others, officials said Monday.

Moscow's forces pounded apartment buildings, offices, data centres and a building of the National Academy of Sciences of Ukraine in downtown Kyiv. The ceaseless Russian drone attacks on cities and towns aim to wear down Ukraine's resistance and cripple the Ukrainian economy.

The attacks followed a week of diplomatic efforts at the United Nations to get traction for negotiations on ending Moscow's invasion that began four and a half years ago.

SpaceX's supersized Starship launches toward orbit for first time

The first-stage booster wasn't meant to return to the Starbase launch site either, instead dropping into the Gulf of Mexico

ASSOCIATED PRESS
New York, September 28

SpaceX launched its enormous Starship toward orbit for the first time Monday, aiming for six full laps around Earth to prove its readiness for NASA's Artemis moon programme.

The company stressed that everything needed to be operating properly before issuing the critical "go" for orbit. A "no-go" call would bring the flight to a quick, early end in the Indian Ocean.

Founder Elon Musk's showpiece rocket – the biggest and most powerful ever built – carried 26 of the latest and most advanced Starlink satellites to join the 11,000 older models already providing internet service.

It was Starship's 14th full-scale launch from Texas' southern tip in three years.

The earlier test flights ventured no farther than the Indian Ocean halfway around the world, often crashing in flames and briefly skimming space.



This time, SpaceX was intent on circling the globe from an altitude of 275 kilometres – not just once but six times over almost 10 hours, ending with a Pacific splashdown near Chile. The first-stage booster wasn't meant to return to the Starbase launch site either, instead dropping into the Gulf of Mexico within minutes of the morning liftoff.

SpaceX wants to ensure that everything works before flying Starship back to Starbase.

If the spacecraft breaks apart over land and rains debris onto people, "our popularity would diminish very rapidly," Musk said at a business summit earlier this month. "That's why we're being extremely cautious here."

If all goes well with this orbital debut, the next Starship will return to the launch pad with giant mechanical arms grabbing the hovering spacecraft.

If the catch works – Musk gives it even or slightly better odds – then SpaceX will refly the spacecraft by year's end or early next.

The 407-foot rocket was designed from the start to be fully reusable – a key to lowering launch costs. SpaceX managed to salvage the last Starship from the Indian Ocean in July.

Engineers modified the newly launched Starship's heat shield based on hands-on inspections from the recovered spacecraft, which is being tugged back to Starbase.

Congo Ebola outbreak tops 8,000 cases

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Bunia, September 28

The number of confirmed cases of Ebola virus in Congo has surged past 8,000, as the country runs out of health workers to contain the deadly disease.

Congo announced an outbreak on May 15, caused by the rare Bundibugyo virus and has struggled to contain it.

PROPOSAL INVOLVES MERGER OF TESS & TCE WITH TATA SONS

Tata Trusts propose Tata Sons rejig to retain its status as private company

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, September 28

Tata Trusts, which own 66 per cent of Tata Sons, have proposed merging two operating companies with the Tata Group's holding company in a restructuring that would allow it to shed its classification as a non-banking financial company and a core investment company, helping it retain its status as an unlisted private company.

The proposed restructuring involves the merger of Tata Electronics Systems Solutions Pvt Ltd (TESS) and Tata Consulting Engineers (TCE) with Tata Sons - the holding company of the salt-to-software, cars and airline conglomerate, according to a statement issued by the Tata Trusts on Monday.

The Trusts, which have vehemently opposed listing the holding company, have asked the Tata Sons board to consider the proposal and take necessary steps, including seeking a prior no-objection certificate from the Reserve Bank of India for the proposed merger. The restructuring is aimed at ensuring the reorganised Tata Sons does not meet the regulatory criteria for either an NBFC or a core investment company, the Trusts said.



Tata Trusts chairman Noel Tata

The proposed restructuring comes against a backdrop of growing differences between Tata Trusts and the board of Tata Sons over its future ownership structure. The Trusts, chaired by Noel Tata since October 2024, have opposed listing Tata Sons and in July 2025 unanimously resolved that efforts should be made to retain the company as an unlisted private entity.

The position gained urgency after RBI classified Tata Sons as an upper-layer NBFC in 2022, a status that carries a regulatory listing requirement. Tata Sons has sought to exit the NBFC framework, but the RBI rejected its request in September, leaving the listing issue unresolved.

The dispute has also spilled into the appointment of Tata Sons Chairman N Chandrasekaran. The Trusts had backed his reappointment for a third five-year term in July 2025, but opposed the board's subsequent decision in 2026 to reappoint him after he indicated he would not seek another term.

Noel Tata and the Trusts argued that the Tata Sons articles required the Trusts' nominee directors' support for the appointment and described the board's decision as invalid. The board has nevertheless backed Chandrasekaran and proceeded with steps linked to regulatory compliance. The latest restructuring proposal offers the Trusts a route to address the listing requirement while preserving Tata Sons as an unlisted private company.

KEY POINTS

- The Trusts, which have vehemently opposed listing the holding company, have asked the Tata Sons board to consider the proposal and take necessary steps
- The proposal would also restore an operating structure that Tata Sons followed for much of its history, when the holding company housed operating businesses alongside its investments in Tata Group firms

"The Tata Trusts today, as majority shareholders with a 66 per cent stake in Tata Sons Private Limited (TSPL), outlined a strategic reorganisation plan for the company which, when given effect to, would ensure that the reorganised entity would neither be an NBFC nor a core investment company," it said in the statement. The proposed reorganisation essentially entails the merger of TESS and TCE with Tata Sons.

As of March 31, 2026, the combined entity would have operating revenue of Rs 105,043 crore, accounting for 64.3 per cent of total income, compared with Rs 40,072 crore of income from financial assets, according to the proposal.

The reorganised entity would have net assets of Rs 200,158 crore, of which investments in group companies would account for Rs 177,120 crore, or less than 90 per cent of total net assets. This would mean it would not meet the principal business criteria for an NBFC or the applicable conditions for a CIC, the Trusts said.

The proposal would also restore an operating structure that Tata Sons followed for much of its history, when the holding company housed operating businesses alongside its investments in Tata Group companies.

Tata Consultancy Services, for example, was a division of Tata Sons until it was demerged into a separate subsidiary in 2004.

The proposed merger will have to comply with the RBI (NBFCs - Voluntary Amalgamation) Directions, 2025, including the requirement for the central bank's prior no-objection certificate. Following completion of the restructuring, Tata Sons would surrender its certificate of registration as a CIC, the Trusts said.

The proposal comes after the boards of the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust & Sir Ratan Tata Trust unanimously resolved in July 2025 that efforts should be made to retain Tata Sons as an unlisted pvt company.

Industrial output surges 8% in Aug on record manufacturing growth

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

India's industrial output grew at its fastest pace in several months in August, expanding 8 per cent year-on-year, government data showed on Monday, driven by a strong performance in manufacturing and electricity generation.

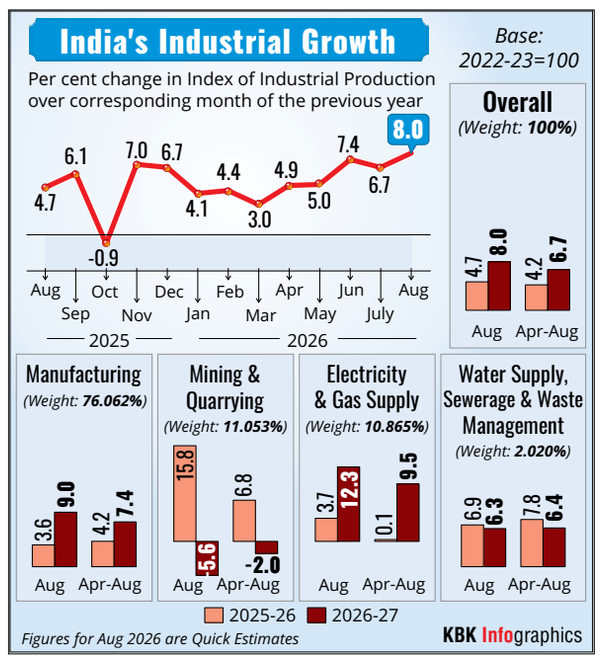
The Index of Industrial Production (IIP) growth accelerated to a revised 7.4 per cent in July, exceeding market expectations and pointing to sustained momentum in factory activity despite a sharp contraction in mining output.

Manufacturing output, which accounts for the bulk of the industrial index, rose 9 per cent in August, following a revised 8.2 per cent increase in July. Electricity generation jumped 12.3 per cent, while mining and quarrying output contracted 5.6 per cent.

"In a record performance, manufacturing sector recorded growth of 8 per cent or more in the last three consecutive months," the Statistics Ministry said.

The August data is the fifth monthly IIP release under India's new series, which uses producer prices to calculate factory output rather than wholesale prices used under the previous methodology.

Within manufacturing, 18 of 23 industry groups recorded year-on-year growth in August. Motor vehicles, electrical equipment and other transport equipment were among the biggest contributors, growing 25.2 per cent, 30.9 per cent and 25.3 per cent, respectively.



The production of consumer durables, including automobiles and mobile phones, rose 11.1 per cent, while consumer non-durables such as food products and toiletries grew 2.1 per cent, reversing a revised 0.8 per cent contraction in July.

Capital goods output rose 16.9 per cent, while intermediate goods increased 13.7 per cent and infrastructure and construction goods grew 6.4 per cent, indicating that the expansion extended beyond consumer-facing sectors.

For the first five months of the financial year, industrial output grew 6.7 per cent, compared with 4.2 per cent in the same period a year earlier. Economists said the data pointed to a broad-based strengthening in industrial activity during the second quarter, supported by domestic and export demand.

"IIP averaged 7.7 per cent in July and August, up from 6.2 per cent in the first quarter," said Dipti Deshpande, principal economist at Crisil. She said manufacturing remained the primary driver, followed by electricity, while capital goods, intermediate goods and consumer durables pointed to a broader-based expansion.

Jio-bp, Nayara cap diesel sales as industrial, other bulk buyers shift to cheaper pump fuel

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 28

Private fuel retailers Jio-bp and Nayara Energy have capped diesel purchases at their outlets as industrial and other bulk consumers turn to petrol pumps for cheaper retail fuel, putting pressure on supplies.

Jio-bp outlets have capped diesel purchases at 50 litres per customer per day, while Nayara Energy outlets have limits ranging from 70 litres to 200 litres, people aware of the matter said.

Public sector retailers Indian Oil Corporation (IOC), Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL) and Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd (HPCL) are also likely to impose restrictions.

Petrol and diesel prices at retail outlets have remained unchanged since May despite international crude prices rising to around $108 a barrel. Meanwhile, prices for bulk consumers have moved more closely with global rates, creating a price gap of up to Rs 40 a litre.

Factories, telecom companies, hotels, malls, data centres and hospitals are among bulk users increasingly buying 400-600 litres from retail outlets, the people said.

The increased purchases are putting pressure on station inventories, with replenishment taking at least a couple of days.

Jio-bp operates 2,227 outlets, while Nayara has 7,105. IOC, BPCL and HPCL have 43,289, 25,587 and 25,238 outlets, respectively.

Jio-bp said its stations are adequately stocked and the measures aim to ensure equitable fuel availability amid prevailing demand dynamics, particularly from industrial and non-transport users.

Jio gains 2.40 mn mobile users in Aug, Airtel 2.11 mn: TRAI data

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 28

Reliance Jio added the highest number of wireless mobile subscribers in August, gaining nearly 2.40 million users, followed by Bharti Airtel with about 2.11 million additions, according to Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) data released Monday.

Jio's wireless mobile subscriber base rose to 508.43 million at the end of August from 506.03 million in July. Airtel's base increased to about 491.60 million from 489.49 million.

Vodafone Idea added about 506,000 subscribers, while state-owned BSNL gained nearly 493,000 users. MTNL lost about 5,900 subscribers.

Overall wireless subscriptions, including mobile and Fixed Wireless Access, rose to 1,312.25 million at end-August, a monthly growth of 0.46 per cent.

Urban subscriptions increased to 759.11 million from 753.86 million, while rural subscriptions rose to 553.14 million from 552.40 million, TRAI said.

Private operators accounted for 92.75 per cent of wireless mobile subscribers, while BSNL and MTNL together held 7.25 per cent. Airtel had 99.01 per cent of its subscriber base active during August. Total telephone subscribers rose to 1,360.70 million.

Gautam Adani, 4 group cos settle minimum public shareholding case with Sebi

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 28

Adani Group Chairman Gautam Adani, four group companies, and 13 others on Monday settled a case pertaining to alleged non-compliance with minimum public shareholding (MPS) rules with markets regulator Sebi by paying a total of Rs 1.48 crore.

The settlement covers Adani Enterprises Ltd, Adani Power Ltd, Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Ltd, and Adani Transmission Ltd, now known as Adani Energy Solutions Ltd, along with their directors and certain other officials.

The proceedings stemmed from complaints received by Sebi in June and July 2020 alleging non-compliance with MPS requirements by certain listed Adani Group companies.

As per the settlement order, each of the four Adani Group companies, Gautam Adani, and 13 others have paid settlement amount of Rs 1.48 crore.

I-T dept extends corporate tax audit report, ITR filing deadline by 3 weeks

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 28

The Income Tax Department on Monday extended by 21 days the due date for filing ITR and submitting tax audit reports by corporates for assessment year (AY) 2026-27.

Corporates will now have to file income tax returns for AY'27 by November 21, instead of October 31. The deadline for submitting tax audit reports has been extended from September 30 to October 21.

In a statement, the CBDT said the due dates for both compliances have been extended.

Tax practitioners had sought an extension, citing a compressed audit window following the August 31 deadline for filing ITRs in non-audit cases.

Nangia & Co LLP Senior Partner Amit Agarwal said the extension showed that the CBDT had taken cognisance of challenges faced by taxpayers and tax professionals during the current compliance cycle.

"The additional 21 days will provide much-needed breathing space to businesses to complete their tax audits, undertake necessary reconciliations and ensure that the information reported in the tax return is accurate and appropriately supported," Agarwal said.

The last date for filing ITR for salaried taxpayers is July 31, while it is August 31 for those with income from business or profession who are not required to get their books audited.

The I-T department earlier said over 7.8 crore ITRs had been filed for AY 2026-27 till August 31.

NALCO showcases Angul Aluminium Park investment opportunities at Kolkata roadshow

MPOST BUREAU
Kolkata, September 28

National Aluminium Company Ltd (NALCO), in association with Odisha Industrial Infrastructure Development Corporation (IDCO), organised a roadshow in Kolkata to showcase investment opportunities at Angul Aluminium Park.

Union Mines Minister G Kishan Reddy said India imports nearly $4 billion worth of high-finish aluminium products, making greater production, value addition and a strong downstream ecosystem key priorities. Mines Secretary Keshav Chandra



NALCO CMD Brijendra Pratap Singh said the park aims to build an integrated downstream aluminium ecosystem around NALCO's operations in Angul. IDCO MD D Prasanth Kumar Reddy highlighted its molten metal corridor and availability of land, water and energy.

NALCO will provide 50,000 tonnes of hot metal annually at a discounted rate. NALCO paid a record dividend of Rs 1,083.06 crore to the Centre for FY 2025-26.

stressed greater value addition and high-value finished products, supported by technology, innovation and indigenous R&D.

India's Russian crude imports fall to 5-month low as refiners diversify supplies

India's total crude imports averaged about 5.3 million bpd in September, up roughly 600,000 bpd from August

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

India's imports of Russian crude fell to about 1.75 million barrels a day in September, their lowest level since April, as refiners diversified purchases amid geopolitical risks, even as the country's overall crude intake rose sharply on stronger refinery runs, according to ship tracking data.

India's total crude imports averaged about 5.3 million barrels a day (MNBPD) in September, up roughly 600,000 barrels per day (bpd) from August and 700,000 barrels a day from a year earlier, according to data from global commodities data and analytics firm Kpler.

India imported an average of 1.74 million bpd of Russian crude in September. The volumes imported were the lowest since 1.58 million bpd of Russian crude imports in April. It compared with 2.02 million bpd of Russian imports in August and 2.65 million bpd in July. Iraq and Saudi Arabia made up for the drop in Russian volumes. Iraq supplied some 575,000 bpd of crude this month, up from 163,000 in August. Saudi volumes also rose to 566,000 bpd in September from 347,000 bpd last month. The UAE supplied 480,000 bpd, down from 546,000 bpd in August.

Sumit Ritolia, Senior Manager (Modelling) at Kpler, said the decline in Russian flows comes as Washington continues to pressure buyers of Russian oil, prompting Indian refiners to keep their sourcing options flexible.

Russia nevertheless remains a major component of India's crude basket, with buying decisions continuing to be driven primarily by economics, availability and refinery compatibility, he said.

CLOSER LOOK

- Iraq & Saudi Arabia made up for the drop in Russian volumes. Iraq supplied some 575,000 bpd of crude this month. Saudi volumes also rose to 566,000 bpd in September
- The UAE supplied 480,000 bpd, down from 546,000 bpd in August

The latest reduction in Russian volumes does not indicate a wholesale shift away from Russian crude, but Indian refiners could exercise greater caution if the US announces unilateral punitive measures targeting India over purchases of Russian oil, he said.

According to Ritolia, during any period of uncertainty, refiners could reduce - rather than halt - Russian purchases while assessing enforcement, potential waivers and the availability of alternative supplies, a pattern seen during previous periods of heightened scrutiny.

The decline in Russian crude has been offset in large part by higher Middle Eastern supplies, he said, adding imports from the region are estimated at about 3 mbd in September, broadly returning to pre-war levels, with higher flows from Iraq, Kuwait and Saudi Arabia. Improving crude movements through the Strait of Hormuz, along with ship-to-ship transfers and other logistical arrangements, have helped Indian refiners rebuild Middle Eastern purchases as regional supply availability improves. African & Venezuelan barrels have also contributed to the diversification of India's crude slate, highlighting refiners' ability to switch between suppliers as relative prices, availability and geopolitical risks change.

Ritolia said the overall increase in crude imports reflects both stronger domestic fuel demand and high refinery utilisation. Export-oriented plants are also running at elevated rates to benefit from strong international product margins and a tight global refined-products market.

"Overall, September highlights the flexibility of Indian refiners to switch between suppliers depending on economics, availability and geopolitical/logistical risks, while keeping crude imports elevated to support strong refinery utilisation," he said.

AIM $200 BILLION IN BILATERAL TRADE BY 2032

India, UAE to step up local currency trade, payment system integration

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, September 28

India and the UAE on Monday agreed to take steps for the timely implementation of initiatives relating to settlement of trade in local currency, integration of payment and messaging systems, and central-bank digital currencies.

These issues are important as they have the potential to make bilateral trade and investment more efficient, accessible and resilient, the commerce and industry ministry said in a statement.

The matters came up for discussion during the 14th meeting of the India-UAE High Level Joint Task Force on Investments (HLJTFI) here. The task force was set up in 2013 to promote trade, investment and economic ties. It acts as a forum to resolve issues faced by investors of the two countries.

It was co-chaired by Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal and Managing Director of Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA) Sheikh Hamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan.



THE MATTERS CAME UP FOR DISCUSSION DURING THE 14TH MEETING OF THE INDIA-UAE HIGH LEVEL JOINT TASK FORCE ON INVESTMENTS (HLJTFI) HERE

"The co-chairs reviewed the progress made by the central banks of the UAE and India on initiatives relating to local-currency settlement, the integration of payment and messaging systems, and central-bank digital currencies. It was noted that these initiatives have the potential to make bilateral trade and investment more efficient, accessible and resilient. The two sides agreed to take steps to work together to support their timely implementation," it said.

The areas where two-way investment flows can be enhanced include energy, industry, logistics, infrastructure, technology and artificial intelligence, space, food security, agricultural innovation and the startup ecosystem.

"Civil aviation cooperation between Abu Dhabi and India was also discussed at the meeting, with the aim of enhancing air connectivity to support the broader economic relationship," it said, adding investment opportunities and collaboration in developing an aviation and logistics hub in Dholera (Gujarat) were also explored.

The bilateral trade has reached $101.25 billion in 2025-26. The non-oil trade touched $76.2 billion last year. The two nations have implemented a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) in May 2022. In August 2024, both partners implemented a bilateral investment treaty (BIT) with the aim of protecting and promoting investments.

As the UAE and India continue to work towards the shared ambition of $200 billion in bilateral trade by 2032, the two continue to expand investment cooperation across the sectors that will drive future growth, including energy, infrastructure, technology and AI. "The two sides reviewed the work of CEPA's relevant subcommittees, discussed ways to further strengthen trade resilience in an increasingly complex geopolitical and economic environment," the ministry said.

Further, they reviewed the progress of several joint investment projects and areas of collaboration, including the Food Park project in Gujarat.

Both sides noted the expected operationalisation of Invest India, a national investment promotion agency, office in the UAE before the end of 2026.

India and the UAE noted recent Emirates NBD's about $3 billion acquisition of a majority stake in RBL Bank of India, and International Holding Company's $1 billion investment in Sammaan Capital of India, as well as a joint investment intent of $11.5 billion in the establishment of an integrated aluminium complex in Odisha.

They also noted the opening of Mashreq Bank, First Abu Dhabi Bank and Abu Dhabi National Insurance Company branch offices in GIFT City in India.

KEY POINTS

- 'The co-chairs reviewed the progress made by the central banks of the UAE and India on initiatives relating to local-currency settlement, integration of payment systems, and central-bank digital currencies
- Bilateral trade has reached $101.25 billion in FY26. The non-oil trade touched $76.2 billion last year
- In August 2024, both partners implemented a BIT with the aim of protecting and promoting investments

Sensex crashes 1,124 pts to 6-month low, while Nifty ends below 22,800

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, September 28

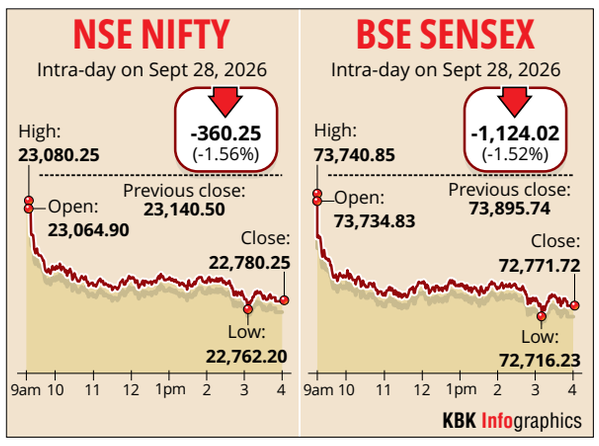
Stock markets tumbled on Monday, with the benchmark Sensex plunging 1,124 points to a six-month low and the Nifty closing below 22,800 as surging crude oil prices, geopolitical uncertainties, and weak global trends hit investor sentiment.

The 30-share BSE Sensex tanked 1,124.02 points, or 1.52 per cent, to settle at 72,771.72, the lowest closing level since March 30, 2026.

The 50-share NSE Nifty dropped 360.25 points, or 1.56 per cent, to end at a near six-month low of 22,780.25. As many as 47 Nifty shares closed lower while three were up, reflecting across-the-board selling.

Analysts said surging crude oil prices following the US-Iran stalemate over the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz, foreign fund outflows, a spike in US bond yields triggered selling in financial, PSU banks, metals, FMCG, oil & gas and auto stocks.

Among the 30 Sensex firms, 29 ended lower. L&T fell the most by 2.81 per cent. Power Grid dropped 2.62 per cent, Adani Ports



RISING OIL PRICES DUE TO US-IRAN STALEMATE OVER HORMUZ REOPENING, FOREIGN FUND OUTFLOWS & SPIKE IN US BOND YIELDS LED TO SELLING IN FINANCIAL, PSBs, METALS, FMCG, OIL & GAS AND AUTO STOCKS

by 2.38 per cent, HDFC Bank by 2.3 per cent, Hindustan Unilever by 2.27 per cent and Reliance Industries by 2.24 per cent. Infosys was the only winner from the pack.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 3.81 per cent to $108.3 per barrel. FIIs offloaded equities worth Rs 3,693.93 crore on Friday, according to exchange data.

The BSE SmallCap Select index tanked 1.90 per cent and MidCap Select index declined 1.39 per cent.

All BSE sectoral indices ended lower. The PSU Bank plummeted 3.25 per cent, Power tumbled 2.30 per cent, Telecom 2.30 per cent, Utilities 2.27 per cent, MidSmall Pvt Banks 2.17 per cent, Industrials 2 per cent, MidSmall Pvt Banks Quality Tilt 1.99 per cent Services 1.93 per cent and Pvt Banks index 1.86 per cent.

On Friday, the Sensex climbed 315.20 points, or 0.43 per cent, to settle at 73,895.74. The Nifty was up 77.40 points, or 0.34 per cent, to end at 23,140.50.

Exports jump 15% till Sept 21 this fiscal: Goyal

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, September 28

India's merchandise exports have risen 15 per cent till September 21 during this fiscal year despite global economic uncertainties triggered by the ongoing wars, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Monday.

Addressing the media after the 14th India-UAE High Level Task Force on Investment meeting here, the minister also said the UAE – India's seventh largest source of foreign direct investment (FDI) – has expressed an intent to invest another $25 billion in the near future, with the ultimate objective of taking its investments in India to $100 billion in the years to come.

"We have increased our merchandise exports by upward of 15 per cent in the first six months (up to September 21) this year, which is a pretty important and significant achievement given the fact that we are living in a world where two wars are going on and the Strait or Hormuz, which is our principal sea route, is facing so much stress," Goyal said.

During April-August this financial year, exports jumped 17.85 per cent year-on-year to $215.91 billion, and imports climbed 18.21 per cent to $363 billion.

'India navigated well in global energy security uncertainty'

MPOST BUREAU
Kolkata, September 28

"India navigated well during the uncertainty over global energy security", said Union Minister of Petroleum & Natural Gas Hardeep Singh Puri, during an exclusive session organised by MCCI on 'India's Energy Security: Navigating Geopolitical Uncertainty,' on Monday at The Park Hotel, Kolkata.

He said that in every crisis, there is a challenge. Challenge throws up opportunities.

Referring to the uncertainty caused by the geopolitical turmoil on energy security, Puri said that it is turbulence, not uncertainty. The duty before the government was to insulate 1.4 billion people from fluctuations. Global energy prices had gone up by more than 70 per cent, while that in India was much lower.



Union Petroleum & Natural Gas Minister Hardeep Singh Puri with Munish Jhajharia, President, MCCI, addressing a session on India's Energy Security: Navigating Geopolitical Uncertainty, on Monday at Pine Hall, Park Hotel, Kolkata.

"This was because of the resolution of the Prime Minister whose mantra was to ensure availability and affordability. The prices of petrol and diesel were slashed thrice by reducing the excise duties", he said.

Puri viewed that the oil marketing companies have been bleeding with huge under recoveries. They are good corporate citizens. But we won't let them sink. When prices are high, upstream companies do well while downstream ones lose.

According to him, the country has navigated well so far. "But this world is full of unpredictability. During the crisis, none of the retail outlets went dry, he said.

Puri said that there is no shortage of energy per se in the world. There is crude availability. The issue is of supply routes. But what will happen if the Strait of Hormuz closes down? Nearly 40% of the global energy supply will get choked.

His anxious moment was not of crude supply. His real concern was of LPG supply as there are 33.5 crore LPG connections almost covering the entire population of the country. There is LNG, but the bulk of the people are dependent on LPG.

Stating that the economy of West Bengal has declined over the last 50 years, he said West Bengal will occupy centre stage due to recent developments.

"Economic progress of West Bengal is of highest priority of the Centre. That is why the India Energy Week is being held here", he said.

He said that the Centre has earmarked Rs 84,000 crore budget of for exploration & production.

Rupee falls 22 paise to 95.97 against US dollar

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, September 28

The rupee depreciated 22 paise to close at 95.97 against the US dollar on Monday, on risk-off sentiments in global markets after the US rejected a deal proposal by Iran, diminishing hopes of reopening of the Strait of Hormuz.

At the interbank forex market, the rupee opened on a negative note at 95.89 against the American currency. The unit touched the day's high of 95.87 before ending the session at 95.97 against the greenback, registering a 22 paise fall from its previous close.

IRFC signs ₹4,200 cr Term Loan Agreement with DVC for Renewable Energy Projects

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 28

Indian Railway Finance Corporation Limited (IRFC), a Navratna Central Public Sector Enterprise under the Ministry of Railways, has taken another significant step in its strategic expansion and diversification with the signing of a Rs 4,200 crore Term Loan Agreement with Damodar Valley Corporation (DVC) to finance its renewable energy projects across Jharkhand and West Bengal.



The transaction marks an important milestone in IRFC's evolving role as a diversified infrastructure financier, extending its established long-term financing capabilities to the clean energy ecosystem while remaining closely aligned with the broader railway ecosystem.

The loan agreement was signed in New Delhi in the presence of senior officials of IRFC and DVC, led from DVC by Manish Kumar, Member (Finance), DVC, and Manoj Kumar Dubey, Chairman & Managing Director, IRFC.

The financing will support DVC's portfolio of floating solar, ground-mounted solar, rooftop solar and Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) projects, leveraging its existing land, reservoirs and transmission infrastructure.

Reddy reviews GSI's activities, future roadmap

MPOST BUREAU
Kolkata, September 28

Union Minister of Coal and Mines G Kishan Reddy reviewed the activities, achievements and future roadmap of the Geological Survey of India (GSI) at a meeting in Kolkata, focusing on mineral security, critical-mineral exploration and advanced technologies.

During Field Season 2026-27, GSI is undertaking around 500 mineral exploration projects, including approximately 300 focused on critical and strategic minerals.

It is also intensifying exploration for concealed and deep-seated deposits using integrated geological, geophysical and geochemical investigations.



Union Minister of Coal & Mines, G Kishan Reddy with Keshav Chandra, Secretary, Ministry of Mines, addressing the review meeting

Reddy stressed accelerated exploration in prospective areas and faster progression of high-potential mineral occurrences from discovery to resource establishment and development. He called for timely, outcome-oriented projects to support domestic supply chains, reduce import dependence and aid India's clean-energy transition.

Mines Secretary Keshav Chandra called for a technology-driven, integrated approach using multidisciplinary datasets, advanced analytical capabilities and inter-agency collaboration.

GSI Director General Varsha Ashok Aglawe outlined plans involving AI/ML, 3D/4D geological modelling, Pan-India magnetotelluric surveys & a nationwide subsurface critical-mineral potential map.

GSI is undertaking 58 Geoinformatics & Data Analysis projects during Field Season 2026-27.

Consumer durables face third price hike as input costs surge

Higher logistics and energy costs and adverse forex movements have added pressure

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 28

Consumer durable makers LG, Daikin, Voltas, Samsung and Godrej are raising prices by up to 10 per cent from October, marking the third hike this year as copper, steel, aluminium and resin costs surge amid higher logistics and energy expenses, according to *Economic Times* reported.

LG will hike AC prices by 5-7 per cent from 1 October 2026, while Voltas will raise prices by 5-7 per cent, Daikin by 6-10 per cent & Godrej by 4-6 per cent. Samsung has already hiked TV prices by Rs 1,000-10,000 across its 43-inch to 75-inch range. Cumulative hikes in some categories have reached 16-18 per cent.

LG told trade partners that copper costs had risen 34 per cent this year, resin 17 per cent, steel 24 per cent and aluminium 16 per cent. In the three months before the latest round, copper rose about 10 per cent, aluminium 5 per cent, steel 13 per cent and resin 18 per cent. Higher logistics and energy costs and adverse foreign-exchange movements have added pressure. The hikes come ahead of Navratri and Diwali, which account for an estimated 25-30 per cent of annual consumer-durables offtake. Manufacturers had initially hoped to limit the pre-Diwali increase to around 2-3 per cent, but continued input-cost pressures have made that difficult.

CLOSER LOOK

- The hikes come ahead of Navratri and Diwali, which account for an estimated 25-30% of annual consumer-durables offtake
- Imported compressors, copper tubes, heat exchangers can transmit global cost shocks to locally assembled products

A BCG-CII report estimates India's consumer-durables market will grow 8-10 per cent annually to Rs 3-3.25 lakh crore by 2030. However, localisation of the bill of materials ranges from 25 per cent to 70 per cent, with TVs and room ACs at the lower end. Imported compressors, copper tubes, heat exchangers and display modules can transmit global cost shocks to locally assembled products.

The report estimates the sector could create an additional Rs 40,000-50,000 crore opportunity for domestic value addition by 2030, with localisation rising to 30-80 per cent. Under the Electronics Component Manufacturing Scheme, the government cleared 31 proposals involving Rs 7,877 crore in August, taking total approved projects to 106 & cumulative investment above Rs 69,000 crore.

Under the White Goods PLI, five firms were selected in January with investments of Rs 863 crore for AC-component manufacturing. The projects are likely to generate production worth Rs 8,337 crore by FY28. The scheme with an overall outlay of Rs 6,238 crore, aims to raise domestic value addition from 20-25 per cent to 75-80 per cent.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



REC Power Development & Consultancy Ltd (RECPDCL) handed over Ranipur Chunar Power Transmission Ltd, the project-specific Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV), to the successful bidder, M/s H G Infra Engineering Limited, on September 26, 2026. The SPV was handed over by Rajesh Raj, Sr. GM & HoD, RECPDCL to Ujjval Verma, CGM (Finance), H G Infra Engineering Ltd.

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS SAMBA
"HUE & CRY NOTICE"

As intimated byDy.SPHqrs Samba vide his communication letter No. Dy.SP/ Hqrs/2026/CB/9310-11 Dated 22.09.2026, that one lady namely Anjali Choudhary W/o GoluChoudhary R/o Madhya Pradesh A/P Arazi Tehsil and District Samba has been missing from Samba area and her missing report has been entered vide DDR No. 08 dated 11.09.2026 of P/S Samba. Her search was conducted but not traced out till date. Through the medium of this Hue and Cry Notice, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing lady may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. **PCR Samba :-01923-246333, 9541649001**
2. **SSP Samba's email ID :- sspsamba@jkpolice.gov.in**

The description roll alongwith photograph of missing lady is as under:-

Name:	Anjali Choudhary
W/o	GoluChoudhary
Permanent Address:	R/o Madhya Pradesh A/P Arazi Tehsil and District Samba
Age:	29 Years
Height:	5 Feet
Complexion :	Wheatish
Face:	Round
Body Structure:	Normal
Languages known:	Hindi
Attire:	Salwar suit green coloured



No. CB/Look/2026/
Dated: - .09.2026

Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police,
Samba

DIP No:DIP/J-11292/26

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS SAMBA
"HUE & CRY NOTICE"

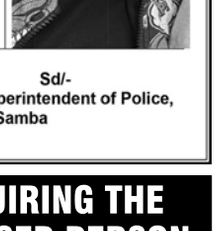
As intimated by Dy.SPHqrs Samba vide his office letter No.Dy. SPHqrs/2026/CB/9312-13 dated 22.09.2026, that the accused person namely Arun Sharma S/o Hardath Kumar R/o DessaChak, ChadwalKathuais involved in case FIR No.190/2026 U/S 137(2)/64 BNS, ¾ POCSO Act of Police Station Samba, the accused is evading his arrest since the registration of the case. The photograph of the said accused person is required to be published/telecast in print/electronic media for his identification/arrest.

As such, a Look-out Notice of above mentionedaccusedperson is being published/telecast on Print/Electronic media for information of Police Establishments so that they could be identified and any information related to them may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. **PCR Samba:- 01923-246333, 9541649001**
2. **SSP Samba's email ID :-sspsamba@jkpolice.gov.in**

The description roll along with photograph of accused person is as under:-

Name:	Arun Sharma
Parentage:	Hardath Kumar
R/O :	DessaChak, ChadwalKathua
Complexion	Fair
Height	5 Feet 04 Inch
Eye Colour:	Black
Hair Colour:	Black



No. CB/Look/2026/
Dated:-.09.2026

Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police,
Samba

DIP No:DIP/J-11291/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mithlesh Kumar, R/o C-22/24, Sector-11, Noida-201301, 2) C-562, Agar Nagar Prem Nagar-3, Kirari Suleman Nagar, North West Delhi-110086** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC NI Act-2058/24, U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Rajouri Garden, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Mithlesh Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Mithlesh Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mithlesh Kumar** accused of **CC NI Act-2058/24, U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Rajouri Garden, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.12.2026.**

By Order - Sh. Gaurav Singal
Judicial Magistrate First Class, West
Room No. 04, Tis Hazar Courts, Delhi

DP/13479/WD/2026

GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB
GREATER MOHALI AREA DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
PUDA Bhawan, Sector 62, SAS Nagar
Tender Notice No. GMADA/D.E (C-1)/2026/1798-1806
dated 28-09-2026

Divisional Engineer (C-1), GMADA invites online bids for **"Construction of sector dividing road 83/101, SAS Nagar alongwlth construction of one number dual carrigeway HL bridge on 200 feet wide sector dividing road Sector 83/101, SAS Nagar including maintenance for 5 years (Civil, Public Health and Electrical Works)."**

Closing date & time: **21-10-2026 at 11:00 AM**
For details log onto: **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**
Note: Any corrigendum(s) to the tender notice shall be published on the above website only.
RO No PR-Advt. No :-1324/12/2026-27/15653

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No.: DyCPMGSURETENDER-06 **Dated: 25.09.2026**

E-Tender Notice

Dy. Chief Project Manager/Gati Shakti Unit /Prayagraj, North Central Railway, acting for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-tenders for the following work through **Open Tender-Single Packet System** :-

Tender No.: GSURETENDER-06	**Approx. Cost of work (Rs.) :** 86443309.99
Name of work : Provision of extension and maintenance of steel structural shed and other related works at Advance Trip maintenance center at electric trip shed Prayagraj under DY.CPM/GSU/PRYJ	
Earnest Money (Rs.) : 1728900.00	**Completion period :** 12 Months
Date of Opening of tender : 21.10.2026 15:30 hrs.	
Similar work for eligibility criteria : Any structural steel fabrication work.	

Note: 1. Tender online can be submitted up to **15:30 hrs. on 21.10.2026**. **2.** The complete information along with tender document of above E-tender are available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in** up to **15:30 hrs.** on the due date of tender opening i.e. **21.10.2026.** **2202/26 (PH)**

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

T. Notice No. 230-Elect/TRD/PRYJ/E-Tender Notice/2026/665 Date: 26.09.2026

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer/TRD/N.C.Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under:-

T. No.: 230-TRD-WC-1054-2026	**Completion Period:** 12 Months
Description of work: Improvement of 25 kV OHE infrastructure at Prayagraj Chheoki (PCOI) and Link Junction (LKJN) Yard in Prayagraj Division.	
Advertised value: ₹6,18,97,060.13	**Bid Security:** ₹ 12,38,000.00
Bidding system: Single Packet	**Tender Closing date & Time:** 17.10.2026 & 14:00 Hrs
Tender Opening date & Time: 17.10.2026 & 15:00 Hrs	

Note:- 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in** 21days prior to the date of opening of the tender. **2.** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. **3.** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. **2206/26(AK)**

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

UJVN Ltd.
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.Q:- "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. ROAD, Dehradun-248006.
Phone :- 0135-2763808 & Fax : 0135-2763508
CIN No. - U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

RO No. 879 **Date: 28.09.2026**

E-TENDER NOTICE

The office of Executive Engineer (Generation), ManeriBhali Stage-II, Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi) invites online bidsfrom interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below :

Tender No: NIT-31/EE (GEN)/MB-II/2026-27, 32/EE (GEN)/MB-II/2026-27

Name of work/Supply/Services:(1) SITC of electric perimeter protection system at 220 kV Switchyard of Dharasu Power House .

(2) Procurement of various spares for CCTV surveillance system at MB-II, Dharasu Power house, Chinyalisaur, Uttarkashi.

Estimated cost: Rs.30,55,350/-, 7,54,220.00/- only + GST extra respectively.

Date of availability of bid document on website:- 29.09.2026

Last date for submission of Bids:- 22.10.2026 up to11:00 Hrs.

For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the e-procurement portal **"http://uktenders.gov.in"**

Executive Engineer (Generation)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No. : - 8320262027 **Dated : 25.09.2026**

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-TENDERS on prescribed form for the following work up to **13:30** hrs. on **21.10.2026.** The details of the Tender are as under:-

1. Tender No. : 177	**Approx Cost of work (Rs.) : 6500000.00**
Name of Work : Horticulture work at Tundla & TDL to DAQ for the P.E. 30.06.2027 under Sr. ADEN/Estate/TDL and Sr. ADEN/TDL.	
Bid Security : 130000.00	**Completion Period : 8 months**
Date of Opening of tender : 21.10.2026	
Eligibility Criteria for similar work : Any Horticulture Work.	
2. Tender No. : 178	**Approx Cost of work (Rs.) : 15065220.90**
Name of Work : Combined Tender for **(A)** Provision of installation of height gauges at 5 Nos. level Crossings in Arshiya Siding. **(B)** Civil Work in Connection with replacement of earthing arrangement along with other associated works for improving earthing system at Aligarh switching station under ADEN/ALJN.	
Bid Security : 301300.00	**Completion Period : 12 months**
Date of Opening of tender : 21.10.2026	
Eligibility Criteria for similar work : Any Civil Engineering Work.	

(1) E-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. **(2)** The complete information along with tender document of above **E-TENDER** is available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in** up to **13:30** hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e., **21.10.2026 (3)** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with **IREPS** website along with Digital Signature Certificate issued by **CCA** under **IT Act-2000. (4)** The tenderers shall submit a copy of certificate as given in tender document in standard format, without which their tender may not be considered and shall be summarily rejected. **(5)** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of **IREPS** may be approached. **(6)** The tenderer has to submit necessary documents in compliance of clause 10 to 18 (Part-I) of GCC April '2022 mandatorily, otherwise offer will be considered as Incomplete offer and accordingly shall not be considered. **2200/26 (C)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONC

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Bank Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	M/s. Yas Concast/ Hardeep Singh/ Yogesh Kumar Aggarwal/ Sant Lal Alias Sant Lal Aggarwal (Guarantor & Mortgagor)/ 775205000117	Property Bearing Municipal Property Id No. 3HVR9YW5 (Old No. 2171), Measuring Area 16 Marla, Comprised In Khata/Khewat No.575/598, Rect No. 249, Killa No.21(3-13), Situated At Patti Gharam, Hodal, Tehsil Hodal, District Palwal, Haryana-121106. Admeasuring An Area of: 16 Marla Bounded By: North: As Per Transfer Deed, South: As Per Transfer Deed, East: As Per Transfer Deed, West: As Per Transfer Deed/ Date of Symbolic Possession September 24, 2026	April 18, 2026 Rs. 68,17,133.36/-	Matura, Palwal

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: September 29, 2026
Place: Palwal

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

GOVERNMENT OF JAMMU AND KASHMIR
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
Mechanical Irrigation Division Anantnag HQ Awatipora Email:xnmidanantnga@gmail.com
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
e-NIT No. 26 MIDA/ 2843-48 OF 2026-27 Dated: 24-09-2026

For and on behalf of Lt. Governor of UT of J&K Executive Engineer, Mechanical Irrigation Division, Anantnag, invites e-tenders on item rate basis by e-tendering mode for the advertised work. The bidding process shall be completed online in two covers viz. **Cover '1st'** consisting of Tender fee, Earnest Money Deposit, Prequalification criteria's, acceptance of General Terms and Conditions and Technical Specifications. **Cover '2nd'** shall consist of Financial Bid in the prescribed BOQ.-

S. No	Name of work	Estimated Cost (Rs in Lacs)	Cost of tender documen t/ (In Rs.)	Earnest money @3%	Time of Completion of work	Class/ Registration Type (Qualification criteria)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
I.	LIS Khudpora-Providing & fitting of busbars/ cable for interconnection of motors and other electrical gadgets at Scheme 1 Stage 2nd.	10.38	500/=	20760/=	30 days	Original Equipment Manufacturers (OEMs) of pumps or registered firms with relevant experience

Position of AA accorded by Superintending Engineer Mechanical Circle Srinagar Vide No. 29-MCO of 2026-27 dt: 13-08-2026
Major Head 4701 UT capex.
Position Of Technical Sanction Accorded vide No. TS/ 2026-27/91 Dated: 08-2026.

	Publish Date	24	09 2026	at	4:00 PM
ii	Document Download/sale start Date	24	09 2026	at	4:00 PM
iii	Bid submission start date	24	09 2026	From	5:00 PM
IV	Bid submission/Document download /sale end Date	01	10 2026	Upto	11:00 AM
V	Date and time of Bid opening	01	10 2026	At 4:00 Noon or any date convenient to the Deptt.	

1. The complete bidding process shall be online on **www.jktenders.gov.in**
2. The pre bid meeting will be held in the office chamber of the Executive Engineer, Mechanical Irrigation Division, Anantnag
3. The Financial bids of the bidders shall be opened online in the office of the Executive Engineer, Mechanical Irrigation Division Anantnag.
4. **In compliance with the instructions issued by the Chief Engineer, Irrigation & Flood Control Department, Kashmir vide letter No. CE/I&FC/DB/6518-47 dated 16.06.2026, all EMD and Tender Fee transactions shall be made through the designated bank account, the details of which are as under:**
5. **Account Name: Chief Engineer Kashmir Irrigation and Flood Control Account Number: 0367010200000608 IFSC Code: JAKAOTANKEE Bank: J&K Bank Ltd., Tankipora Branch** OR
6. **Earnest Money in the form of CDR/FDR/BG/Insurance security Bond** to be pledged in favour of Executive Engineer, Mechanical Irrigation Division, Anantnag HQ Awantipora of any slidkIBank. The Date of EMD & Tender Fee must be between the date of start of bid and Bid Submission End date.
The cost of downloaded tender documents should be in form of TR/e-challan in favourof Executive Engineer MID Anantnag HQ Awantipora payable at Awantipora and to be deposited in M.H: 0702 OR Online submission of Tender Document Fee ACCOUNT NO 0334010200000060 J&K Bank Ltd Awantipora
7. Note: the bidders are advised to read all conditions laid down in the NIT Carefully before uploading softcopy any short fall found in the soft copy the tender shall be rejected.
8. **All Bidders have to submit an EMD amount equal to 2% of estimated value as bid security and the acknowledgement of the online EMD transaction shall be uploaded with the bid.**
9. The bid shall remain open for acceptance for a period of 180 days from the date of opening of bids. If any bidder/ tenderer withdraws his bid/tender before the said period or makes any modifications in the terms and conditions of the bid, His earnest money shall stand forfeited.
10. Other details can be seen in the bidding documents from the website **http://jktenders.gov.in.**
11. Queries hby email if any should be made at **xnmidanantnga@gmail.com**
13. Conditional tenders shall not be accepted.
14. Intending bidders are advised to download attached Annexures "Instructions to bidders regarding e-Tendering Process" and "General Instructions for bidders" and go through its contents before uploading their bids

MIDA/2843-48 Date:24-09-2026.
Date: 24/09/2026
DIP No:DIPK-6165/26

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
Mechanical Irrigation Division Anantnag HQ Awantipora

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Victor** S/o Okafor Jude R/o Near Jeet Property, Chander Vihar, Delhi, Permanent Address : Uli, Anambra, Nigeria has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence FIR No. 1559/2023 u/s 21(b)/29 NDPS at P.S. Nihal Vihar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Victor** cannot be found and whereas it ha been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Victor** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Victor** accused of FIR No. 1559/2023 u/s 21(b)/29 NDPS at P.S. Nihal Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.10.2026.**

By Order: Sh. Salender Malik
Additional Sessions Judge (Spl. Judge NDPS), (West)
Room No. 132,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/13500/OD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT
See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sagar, S/o: Vijender, R/o: H.No. 462, Mojpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **E-FIR No. 30893/2022, U/s: 379/411/34 IPC, Police Station Kotwali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sagar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sagar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sagar** of **Police Station Kotwali, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.11.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Sayesha Chadha
JMFC-08, Room No. 272
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/13812/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Rashid Ali S/o** Md. Khurshid **R/o** H.No. 221, Gali No. 14, 5th Pusta, Bhajanpura, North East, Delhi, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 347/2019 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act**., has been registered at **PS: Jyoti Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Rashid Ali** namely cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Rashid Ali** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Rashid Ali** of under **FIR No. 347/2019 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act**., Registred at: **PS: Jyoti Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.11.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Rahul Saini
Ld. JMFC-08, Room No. 06
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/13654/NE/2026
(Court Notice)

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform public in general that Kotak Mahindra bank Ltd has organized an auction in below mention respect of Vehicles.

VEHICLES FOR SALE

1) 1)EICHR_VECV EICPRO2114
REG. NO. HR55AL7533-YOM- 2024

UNDER HYPOTHECATION WITH M/S KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK IS UNDER SALE IN ITS "AS IS WHERE IS CONDITION" INTERESTED PARTIES CAN GIVE THEIR QUOTATIONS WITH IN 7 DAYS AT BRANCH ADDRESS: KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK 3RD FLOOR, PLOT NO 7, SECTOR 125, NOIDA-201313 OR CONTACT : PUNIT PARASHAR KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK LTD. CONTACT NO. 8377905498 EMAIL-punit.parashar@kotak.com

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

T. Notice No. 230-Elect/TRD/PRYJ/E-Tender Notice/2026/664 Date : 26.09.2026

E- Tender Notice

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer/TRD/N. C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under: -

Tender No.: 230-TRD-WC-1053-2026, **Description of work:** 25kV OHE Modification work due to Raising of Platform Up to high level at Jalesar (JLS), Hathras (HRS) & Barhan (BRN) stations of Prayagraj Division.	
Advertised Value : ₹ 49,95,308.35	**Bid Security :** 99,900.00
Completion Period : 12 Months	**Bidding System :** Single Packet
Tender Closing Date & Time : 17.10.2026 & 14:00 Hrs.	
Tender Opening Date & Time : 17.10.2026 & 15:00 Hrs.	

Note: - (1) The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in** 21days prior to the date of opening of the tender. **(2)** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with **IREPS** website along with Digital Signature Certificate. **(3)** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of **IREPS** may be approached. **2205/26 (MG)**

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Vinay Kumar, S/o:** Matelu, **R/o:** Gali No. 7, C-Block, Sunday Bazar Road, Nathupura, Burari, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 390/2022, U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC, P.S.: Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Vinay Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Vinay Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Vinay Kumar** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 390/2022, U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC, P.S.: Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07 (North)
Room No. 06, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/13473/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF Sh. Mohommad Sageer
Additional Civil Judge
(Senior Division), Rohtak
Deepak son of Late Krishan
Vs.
General Public
CNR No. HRRH02-001850-2025
Next Date 18-11-2026

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
General Public
:-
India

In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **18-11-2026** at **10:00 am.**

For details logon to **https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?trs = district notice & district = Rohtak**

Sd/- Sh. Mohommad Sageer
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division),
Rohtak

dated 24.09.2026

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Ms. Anuradha
Civil Judge (Senior Division), Hisar
Ranjeet Singh
Vs.
Jaswant Singh@Kaka Singh

Suit for Declaration to the effect that release deed bearing No 768 dated 21.4.2015 executed by defendant No 1 in favour of defendants No 2 to 4 and subsequent mutation No 3698 dated 30.4.2015 entered and sanctioned on the basis of above said release deed regarding the land measuring 33 kanals 0 Marla comprised in khewat No 1966/1001 khatoni No 1220 as per jamabandi for the 2016- 16 situated at Village Bir Tehsil and Distt. hisar is without authority collusive, fraudulent to defeat the rights of the plaintiff.

CNR No. HRHS02-003117-2019
Next Date:-11-11-2026

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
Kamal
Son: :-Jaswant Singh @ Kaka Singh
R/o. House. No. 175-A Model Town Fatehabad

In above titled case, the defendant (s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **11-11-2026** at **10:00 am.**

For details logon to **https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod = district notice & district = Hisar**

Sd/- Ms. Anuradha
Civil Judge (Senior Division),
Dated 24-09-2026 Hisar,

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSONS
(See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **(1) Naman S/o Jagvinder R/o H.No.519, Parva Pana, Village Karala, Delhi, (2) Rahul S/o Satpal R/o Village Karala, Delhi, (3) Ashish S/o Satvir Singh R/o H.No. 818, Village Karala, Delhi, (4) Amit @ Ashu Mathur S/o Bijender Singh R/o H.No. 519, Parwa Pana, Village Karala, Delhi and (5) Kunal @ Kaku, S/o Ravinder, R/o H.No. 1045, Village Karala, Delhi** have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.334/2026, Dated 16.06.2026, u/s 115(2)/140(2)/127(2)/351(2)/3(5)/109(1) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and 10 POCSO Act, P.S. Kanjhawala, Delhi** and it have been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Naman, Rahul, Ashish, Amit @ Ashu Mathur and Kunal @ Kaku** cannot be found and whereas it have been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Naman, Rahul, Ashish, Amit @ Ashu Mathur and Kunal @ Kaku** have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Naman, Rahul, Ashish, Amit @ Ashu Mathur and Kunal @ Kaku** of **FIR No.334/2026, Dated 16.06.2026, u/s 115(2)/140(2)/127(2)/351(2)/3(5)/109(1) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and 10 POCSO Act, P.S. Kanjhawala, Delhi** are required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **02.11.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Neeti Suri Mishra
Additional Session Judge (FTSC)
(POCSO) North-West, Room No.318
Third Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/13732/RD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sunita Devi, W/o: Manoj Singh, R/o: E-1/133, Laxmi Vihar, Prem Nagar-3, Kirari, Suleman Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in **Case Reg. No. 1741/2024, U/s: 138 NI Act, Police Station Prem Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sunita Devi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sunita Devi** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sunita Devi** of **Police Station Prem Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.10.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Sanyam Jain
JMFC-04, North-West, Room No. 112
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/13709/RD/2026

Briefs

Ban on Ethan Mbappe

NYON: Ethan Mbappé will serve a three-game ban in the Champions League for his red card in an opening loss against Real Betis, UEFA said Monday.

Mbappé had been charged with "assaulting another player" for striking Betis defender Natan with an elbow during the Spanish side's 3-2 win at Lille three weeks ago. Natan had appeared to say something as he passed behind Mbappé, whose reaction was spotted on video review.

It was just a third career game in the Champions League for the 19-year-old younger brother of Real Madrid star Kylian Mbappé.

Ethan Mbappé faced a mandatory ban for Lille's visit to Arsenal on Oct. 13 and now also will miss hosting Galatasaray and an away game at Bodø/Glimt. He can return Nov. 25 when Lille hosts Bayern Munich.

RCB release Grace Harris

NEW DELHI: Defending champions RCB on Monday decided to release destructive Australian batter Grace Harris ahead of the 2027 WPL auction in Kochi on October 28.

BCCI's player retention deadline ended on Monday with five teams retaining 63 players including 23 overseas recruits.

Australian star all-rounder Elysse Perry, who was not part of RCB's triumphant campaign in 2026, has made herself available for the next edition beginning on January 14. RCB released four players in total including Harris, D Hemalatha, Gautami Naik and Linsey Smith.

"A total of 27 slots, including 7 overseas slots remain available ahead of the auction," said the BCCI in a release.

UP Warriorz will go into the auction with a maximum purse of INR 3.65 crore, having released the most number of players - 9. Among their released players are Kiran Navgire and Deandra Dottin.

Delhi Capitals, who have lost all the four finals of WPL, released Australian leg spinner Alana King among six players. The others who were let go include Sneh Rana and Lizelle Lee.

MANU BHAKER ENDS MEDAL-LESS

Silver for shooter Esha, runner Gulveer

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Raipur, September 28

Young shooter Esha Singh's tenacity fetched her a silver in the women's individual 25m pistol, while distance runner Gulveer Singh's rampaging form translated into another second-place finish on a rain-soaked day dotted with many missed opportunities and some surprises for India at the Asian Games here.

Gulveer, who has already claimed the 10,000m silver, added another one to his kitty with a personal best timing of 3:36.72sec in the men's 1500m competition. This was after 21-year-old Esha survived five shoot-offs to clinch perhaps the most hard-fought silver of her career.

Kurash player Picky Balhara threw up a pleasant surprise with her bronze in the -78kg category. She became a two-time Games medallist and thereby the most successful Indian Kurash player at the mega-event by adding to her silver from the 2018 edition.

Another brilliant performance was by Vithya Ramraj in the women's 400m hurdles competition as she surged past the legendary P T Usha's over four decade-old national record to claim the bronze medal. Ramraj clocked 54.75sec, bettering Usha's 55.42sec established at the 1984 Los Angeles Olympics.

The medal haul stood at 41, including four gold, 18 silver and 19 bronze medals. The country was placed just outside the top 10, something that has remained consistent since the start of the Games.

In the boxing ring, Olympic bronze-medallist Lovlina Borgohain (75kg), Priya Ghanghas (60kg) and Kapil Pokhariya (90kg) delivered trademark assured performances to sail into semifinals and be assured of bronze, joining three others in the medal rounds.

Among the shockers was defending women's individual compound archery champion Jyothi Surekha Vemman's pre-quarterfinal exit, landing another blow to a largely underwhelming campaign so far by India.

Another defending champion who failed to protect his crown was track veteran Avinash Sable in the men's 3000m steeplechase competition. He ended fifth despite a season's best effort of 8:21.67sec.

Also, the embattled Manu Bhaker signed off without a medal after failing to come good in either team or the individual 25m women's pistol competition.

Action at the shooting range was pretty intense on the day, with Esha redeeming herself following team competition disaster in which Rahi Sarnobat was left devastated by an extraordinary mishap that saw one of her shots register zero after it went into the frame on day 2 of qualification.

The error proved particularly costly for India's team medal prospects, as the trio of Esha, Manu and Sarnobat slipped from third place to fifth in the standings, with an aggregate of 1727.

Esha gathered herself after this disaster to excel in the individual competition. The world No. 1 in the event, she endured aching arms and shoulders, survived a series of heart-stopping eliminations and pushed herself to the very limits in one of the most dramatic finals of the Games. The gold, though, slipped through Esha's grasp in a nerve-shredding shoot-off against China's Jiaruixuan Xiao, who is also the Tokyo Olympics bronze-medallist.

Esha first survived three shoot-offs against North Korea's Kim Hyon Suk, who settled for bronze, before engaging in two more against Xiao in the battle for gold.

The Indian men's cricket moved into the semifinals without so much as turning up for the toss after their quarterfinal clash against Afghanistan was washed out. Shreyas Iyer's men moved ahead on the basis of being higher-ranked at world number one as against Afghanistan's 10th position globally.

After delivering two individual silvers and a bronze in mixed doubles, the squash players began the team competition confidently.

The Indian men's and women's teams marched into the quarterfinals with the latter producing a gritty win over Japan here.



Esha Singh poses with the national flag after winning the silver medal during Asian Games PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- This was after 21-year-old Esha survived five shoot-offs to clinch perhaps the most hard-fought silver of her career
- The medal haul stood at 41, including four gold, 18 silver and 19 bronze medals



Gulveer Singh celebrates after winning silver medal in men's 1500 meter final even, in Nagoy PTI

Asiad: India blank B'desh 10-0 in final group fixture

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kakamigahara, Sept 28

Defending champions India blanked Bangladesh 10-0 amid heavy downpour in their final group fixture of the Asian Games here on Monday with captain Harmanpreet Singh scoring a hat-trick.

India finished on top of Pool A and set up a blockbuster semi-final against arch-rivals Pakistan on October 1. The other semi-final will be played between Malaysia and South Korea.

India dominated Pool A with wins over Indonesia, Sri Lanka, Japan, South Korea and Bangladesh - finishing with a goal difference of +45.

The team will now have a well-deserved two-day break before the all-important semifinals.

India's goals came via Abhishek (3), Jugraj Singh (22) Harmanpreet Singh (27, 40, 45), Sukhjeet Singh (32), Lakra Shilanand (44, 45), Sanjay (59) and Mandeep Singh (60).

Rain left the pitch and the players drenched, making movement difficult. But the much fitter Indian team was better prepared for the rain-hit conditions. The start of the match was delayed by 30 minutes after the game between Pakistan and Oman had to be suspended for about 15 minutes amid heavy rain, forcing adjustment of timings for subsequent matches in the day.

India made their intentions clear early on and opened the scoring in the 3rd minute.Sanjay joined the attacking build-up and despite finding himself at a tight angle inside the Bangladesh circle, he showed good awareness to find Abhishek.

The forward shifted slightly to his left before unleashing his trademark reverse hit that flew past the Bangladesh goalkeeper to give India a 1-0 lead.

India continued to build attacks consistently but struggled to add to their advantage in the opening quarter. Bangladesh earned a penalty corner in the 12th minute, with Amirul Islam producing a decent drag-flick, but goalkeeper Suraj Karkera was alert to the danger and kicked the ball away.



Vithya Ramraj wins bronze in women's 400m hurdles

Ramraj beats PT Usha's four-decade-old record

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nagoya, September 28

India's Vithya Ramraj clinched a bronze medal in the women's 400m hurdles event but long-distance runner Avinash Sable failed to defend his gold medal, finishing fourth in the men's 3000m steeplechase final at the Asian Games here on Monday.

Ramraj clocked a personal best of 54.75 seconds to break a more than four-decade-old national record created by the legendary P T Usha and win a second medal at the ongoing edition of the quadrennial event. She was a part of the silver-winning the 4x400m mixed relay team.

The 28-year-old from Coimbatore finished behind UAE's Mariam Kareem, who won gold with a Games record 54.31 seconds, and Kazakhstan's Adelina Zems, who took silver with a personal best of 54.58sec.

Ramraj bettered Usha's 55.42sec effort that came in the 1984 Olympics in Los Angeles. Usha is currently heading the Indian Olympic Association and is in attendance at the Games.

"Medal is in our hands, but time is not. This race will not come tomorrow or yesterday. Today is our day, so I was going for the timing, not the medal," she said after the race. "My coach said we would go 54 seconds. I did it, and I am so happy. The timing was so good, so I am very happy.

"Everyone has been asking me because I had not gone under 55 seconds for three years. My coach Nehpal Singh Rathore told me to go fast, then maintain it through the sixth hurdle.



Kohli scales 'Mount 15K' quicker than Tendulkar but comparisons unfair

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 28

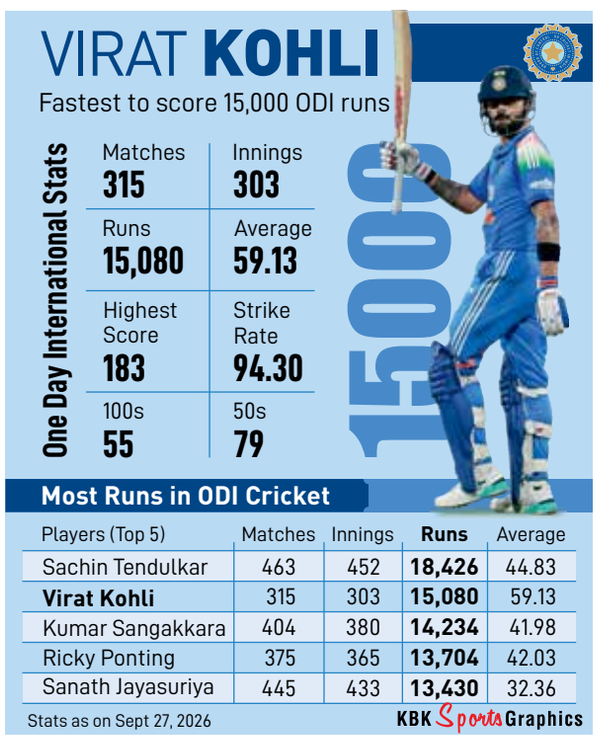
Virat Kohli reached 15,000 ODI runs in 74 fewer innings compared to the peerless Sachin Tendulkar but does this mean that he has well and truly surpassed the 'Mumbai Master' in the format?

The answer may not be as simple as the statistics suggest because the 50-over game that Tendulkar played for over two decades was very different in its rules and texture.

Kohli and Tendulkar are both geniuses, both are unique for the times that they ruled and hence not comparable by mere number-crunching.

But is Kohli a bigger phenomenon than Tendulkar in ODIs? In some cases yes but such a comparison can never be linear.

But both of them have a couple of landmarks to their credit, which are unlikely to be touched by anyone else in near future.



Kohli's number of hundreds, which is 55 and still counting, and Tendulkar's quantum of runs, 18,426. Kohli has 15080 runs to his credit in the format and it is virtually impossible for him to surpass Tendulkar given the dwindling ODI count in the calendar.

In terms of innings played -- Kohli had reached 15,000 ODI runs in his 303rd innings (315th match) while Tendulkar had reached the same milestone in 377 innings (387 matches).

Even more striking is that Kohli took 1578 lesser deliveries than Tendulkar to hit the mark.

Tendulkar faced 17,528 balls to reach 15,000 runs while for Kohli the volume of deliveries faced to achieve the same milestone was 15,950 balls.

Kohli played at least nine per cent fewer balls which indicates that he scored the runs at a faster clip than the 'Master Blaster'.

Kohli's average runs per innings compared to Tendulkar's is also significantly more.

Kohli's runs-per-innings figure stands at 49.5 compared to Tendulkar's 39.9.

The batting average (when unbeaten knocks are computed) is 58.8 for Kohli compared to Tendulkar's 44.24 which was considered to be brilliant for his peak era -- between 1995-2011.

News at a glance



Yashvir Singh competes in the men's javelin throw final at Asian Games in on Monday PTI

Kapil backs Indian golfers to make mark at Asian Games

NEW DELHI: Legendary cricketer and DP World Professional Golf Tour of India president Kapil Dev on Monday backed India's golfers to make their mark at the Asian Games in Japan, urging the six-member contingent to play fearlessly and draw inspiration from the honour of representing country.

Kapil extended his best wishes to the Indian men's and women's teams ahead of the golf competition, which will feature Yuvraj Sandhu, Saptak Talwar and Veer Ahlawat in the men's section and Aditi Ashok, Diksha Dagar and Pranavi Urs in the women's event.

Neeru Dhanda leads Indian hunt for historic trap gold

NAGOYA: Neeru Dhanda is breaking new ground in Indian women's shotgun shooting. The world No. 13 took the sole lead in the women's trap qualification at the Asian Games on Monday, moving closer to an elusive individual gold that no Indian woman has won before.

Fresh from becoming the first Indian woman to win an ISSF World Cup gold in shotgun, at Lonato, the heartland of the sport, the 26-year-old picked up from where she had left off on the opening day, underlining her credentials as a serious contender for the title.

Lovlina, Priya, Kapil punch their way into semifinals

NISHIO: Lovlina Borgohain's medal collection continued to swell as the seasoned Indian boxer assured herself of a second consecutive Asian Games podium finish by moving to the semifinals while Priya Ghanghas and Kapil Pokhariya too advanced to the last four stage here on Monday.

Lovlina notched a commanding 5-0 win over South Korea's Seong Suyeon in the women's middleweight (75kg). Asian Championship gold medallist and reigning Commonwealth Games champion Priya then came from behind to also register a unanimous decision victory.

ASSURED OF ASIAN GAMES MEDAL

Lovlina, Priya, Kapil punch their way into semifinals

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nishio, September 28



Lovlina Borgohain's medal collection continued to swell as the seasoned Indian boxer assured herself of a second consecutive Asian Games podium finish by moving to the semifinals while Priya Ghanghas and Kapil Pokhariya too advanced to the last four stage here on Monday.

Lovlina notched a commanding 5-0 win over South Korea's Seong Suyeon in the women's middleweight (75kg).

Asian Championship gold medallist and reigning Commonwealth Games champion Priya then came from behind to also register a unanimous decision victory over Tajikistan's Mijgona Samadova in the 60kg quarterfinal.

Pokhariya, one of only three boxers to miss out on the podium at last month's Commonwealth Games in Glasgow, then out-punched South Korea's Kim Gichae 0-5 to storm into the men's 90kg semifinal.

Six Indian boxers including Parveen Hooda (65kg), Ankush Panghal (80kg) and Narender Berwal (+90kg) will thus return with medals from the continental tournament, improving on last edition's four-medal haul.

Lovlina, the Tokyo Olympics bronze medallist, had won silver at the previous edition in Hangzhou in 2023.

With the Commonwealth Games silver she won last month, the Assam boxer has now won medals at all the big-ticket events, including the World Championships, Asian Games, Asian Championships and World Cup.

"I'm very happy because this was my first match, and I did well. I have fought her twice before."

"It feels very special to me. Japan is very special to me because my life changed because of Japan. I won a bronze medal at the Tokyo 2020 Olympics.

"And now I'm back here at the Asian Games. I'm very happy, and I feel as if Japan is my second home. "Last time at the Asian Games (Hangzhou 2022) I won a silver medal, so I will try to change the colour this time," she added.

Lovlina started on the offensive with her 1-2 combination. She employed her jab and cross effectively to unsettle Seong, who struggled to connect despite having a slight height advantage.

In the second round, Lovlina continued to land clean combinations of crosses and hooks, but was slightly vulnerable in defence as Seong threw a barrage of punches.

The closely contested round round saw the Korean enjoy better range with her height advantage, but Lovlina was more agile and quicker with her movement. Her punches were also cleaner and more effective.

She will take on reigning 70kg world champion Natalya Bogdanova of Kazakhstan in the last four stage.

Priya began cautiously, taking time to assess her opponent's range. She landed two sharp crosses and repeatedly targeted the body, but her tendency to dip her head too low earned her the referee's warning a couple of times.

The youngster struggled to land cleanly as the more experienced Samadova worked effectively from range, picking her punches and keeping Priya at the end of her shots.

HIGHLIGHTS

- **Lovlina notched a commanding 5-0 win over South Korea's Seong Suyeon in the women's middleweight (75kg)**
- **Six Indian boxers including Parveen Hooda (65kg), Ankush Panghal (80kg) and Narender Berwal (+90kg) will thus return with medals from the continental tournament**

बिहार सरकार

अधीक्षक का कार्यालयः पटना चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय अस्पताल, पटना

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

पटना चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय अस्पताल, पटना के आन्तरिक सुरक्षा व्यवस्था, अपराधिक गतिविधि का पहचान एवं कार्य व्यवस्था का सतत् निगरानी हेतु विभिन्न विभागों/वार्डो/आकस्मिकी आदि एवं आवश्यकतानुसार अस्पताल के अन्य स्थलों पर सी0सी0टी0भी0 कैमरा, एन0 भी0 आर0, मोनिटर एवं यू0पी0एस0 के अधिष्ठापन एवं संचालन हेतु द्वि–बोली प्रणाली के अन्तर्गत सीलबंद निविदा स्पीड पोस्ट/ निबंधित डाक से आमंत्रित की जाती है।

इस सम्बन्ध में विस्तृत जानकारी वास्ते अधीक्षक कार्यालय, पटना चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय अस्पताल, पटना से निविदा प्रकाशन के पश्चात् सम्पर्क –समन्वय स्थापित कार्य–दिवसों में कार्यालय अवधि के बीच प्राप्त किया जा सकता है। निविदा संबंधित सभी जानकारी बेबसाइट www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखा एवं डाउनलोड किया जा सकता है।

Last date and time for receipt of tender :	21-10-2026 up to 5.00 PM
Place of submission of Tender :	Superintendent, Patna Medical College Hospital, Ashok Raj Path, Patna- 800004
Time and date of opening of Tender :	23-10-2026 at 12.30 PM in the Chamber of Superintendent, PMCH, Patna

अधीक्षक,
पटना चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय अस्पताल
पटना

विस्तृत जानकारी **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।
PR. No.012660 (Health) 2026-27

नशे से बनानी दूरी है, क्योंकि परिवार जरूरी है।

Govt. of Bihar

Mines and Geology Department
District- Rohtas
Notice Inviting E-Auction for Settlement of Stone Blocks
(Through MSTC over https://www.mstcecommerce.com)

बिहार खनिज (समानुदान, अवैध खनन, परिवहन एवं भंडारण निवारण) नियमावली, 2019 (समय–समय पर यथा संशोधित) में उल्लेखित प्रावधानों के तहत अनुमोदित जिला सर्वेक्षण प्रतिवेदन में सृजित पत्थर भूखण्डों की अगामी पाँच वर्षों के लिए बंदोबस्ती निम्न कार्यक्रमानुसार करायी जाएगी :–

1. ई–नीलामी कार्यक्रमः–

क्र0 स0	पत्थर भूखण्ड का नाम	ई–नीलामी से पूर्व प्री–बीड बैठक एवं प्रशिक्षण का समय एवं स्थान	निविदा दस्तावेज बिक्री शुल्क (10,000/–रू0) जमाकर निविदा दस्तावेज डाउनलोड प्रारंभ करने की तिथि	अग्रधन राशि ऑनलाईन जमा करने तथा निविदा दस्तावेज अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि	तकनीकी निविदा की जाँच एवं मूल्यांकन हेतु संबंधित समाहर्त्ता द्वारा डाउनलोड करने की तिथि	तकनीकी निविदा की जाँच/ मूल्यांकन कर सफल निविदादाताओं की सूची सिस्टम में संबंधित समाहर्त्ता द्वारा अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि	ई–नीलामी प्रारंभ होने की तिथि एवं समय	ई–नीलामी समाप्ति की तिथि एवं समय
01	गायघाट पत्थर ब्लॉक संख्या – 01	06.10.2026 समाहरणालय, सासाराम सभाकक्ष में समय 11:00 बजे पूर्वाह्न से 01:00 बजे अपराह्न तक	08.10.2026	19.11.2026	20.11.2026	27.11.2026	30.11.2026 पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे से	30.11.2026 अपराह्न 01:00 बजे तक
02	गिजवाही पत्थर ब्लॉक संख्या – 02						30.11.2026 अपराह्न 03:00 बजे से	30.11.2026 अपराह्न 05:00 बजे तक

2. पत्थर भूखण्डों की विस्तृत विवरणी अनुलग्नक–6 के रूप में संलग्न है। साथ ही पत्थर भूखण्डों की विवरणी एवं KML File जिला के वेबसाईट–https://rohtas.bih.nic.in एवं MSTC पोर्टल https://www.mstcecommerce.com पर भी उपलब्ध है।
3. पत्थर भूखण्डों की बंदोबस्ती ई–नीलामी प्रक्रिया के माध्यम से MSTC पोर्टल https://www.mstcecommerce.com से करायी जाएगी।
4. ई–नीलामी द्वारा कराई जा रही बंदोबस्ती में भाग लेने वाले निविदादाता को MSTC पोर्टल https://www.mstcecommerce.com पर पंजीयन कराना अनिवार्य होगा।
5. एतद् संबंधी समस्त सूचना (यथा– नीलामी कार्यक्रम, सुरक्षित जमा राशि, अग्रधन राशि, नीलामी प्रोसेसिंग शुल्क इत्यादि) विस्तृत रूप से जिला के वेबसाईट https://rohtas.bih.nic.in विभागीय वेबसाईट https://state.bihar.gov.in/mines/ CitizenHome.html एवं MSTC पोर्टल https://www.mstcecommerce.com पर उपलब्ध है।
6. ई–नीलामी कार्यक्रम को रद्द/स्थगित/संशोधित करने का अधिकार समाहर्त्ता, रोहतास (सासाराम) के पास सुरक्षित होगा।
7. एतद् संबंधी समस्त सूचना हेतु MSTC, दारोगा राय पथ, पटना–800001 के दूरभाष संख्या/मोबाईल–8269000225/9899972556, Toll Free/ Help Desk Number.:–0612–2506169/7969066600/समाहर्त्ता द्वारा प्राधिकृत पदाधिकारी के मो0 सं0–8544510737, आई0टी0 मैनेजर, रोहतास (सासाराम) के मो0 सं0–9771459354 से सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है।

❖ विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** पर देखा जा सकता है।

समाहर्त्ता,
रोहतास (सासाराम)

विस्तृत जानकारी **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।
PR. No.012672 (Mine) 2026-27

नशे से बनानी दूरी है, क्योंकि परिवार जरूरी है।

Name Change

I, Lalit Kumar Choudhary S/o Lt. Sh. P D Choudhary R/o H.No 2107 Sector-9, Faridabad Haryana, do hereby solemnly affirm & declare That my some documents written as Lalit Kumar Choudhary & some documents name written Lalit Kumar. That Lalit Kumar Choudhary & Lalit Kumar are both name the same person. That in case in future my both name against any dispute arises than I will responsible for the same.

DPHQ Udhampur
NO:-CB/Look Out Notice/2026/65018-28
Dated: - 26 - 09-2026

LOOK OUT NOTICE

As requested by Dy.SP Hqrs. Udhampur that on 24.09.2026 it was learnt from reliable sources at P/S Rehambal that one un-identified dead body of male person is found lying at Dudhar Nallah, near Ladhyala Bridge under suspicious circumstances. In order to ascertain the actual cause of death of the deceased, an inquest proceeding U/S 194 BNSS has been initiated by P/S Rehambal vide DDR No. 19 dated 24.09.2026. The dead body of the deceased is kept at mortuary room of GMC Udhampur for identification and post-mortem. The Photograph with descriptive roll of deceased is as under:-

Photo	Description	
	Age:	About 38-40 years
	Build:	Medium
	Height:	5'11"
	Wearing:	Sky blue T-Shirt & brown trouser

It is therefore requested that, if any missing report of such person has been entered in your respective police units/jurisdiction or any clue leading to the identification of said deceased person, immediate information may kindly be shared on the below mentioned Telephone Nos./Fax/e-mail address for further course of action.

Email: sspoudh@ jkpolice.gov.in
Fax: 01992-270027
Phone: 01992-2270210
PCR Udhampur: 01992-276915
SHO P/S Rehambal: 9697100100

DIP No:DIP/J-11293/26

SSP Udhampur.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ankleshwar Mishra @ Monu, S/o:** Sh. Dinesh Kumar, **R/o:** RC-22, Ram Krishna Appartment Khoda Colony Ghaziabad UP, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 367/2025 U/s 103(1)/109/191(1)/191(2)3(5) BNS P.S.: Gazipur, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ankleshwar Mishra @ Monu,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ankleshwar Mishra @ Monu,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Ankleshwar Mishra @ Monu,** accused of **FIR No.: 367/2025 U/s 103(1)/109/191(1)/191(2)3(5) BNS P.S.: Gazipur, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.10.2026**.

By Order
Amit Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06,
East District, Court No. 12,
Karkarduma Courts, East Delhi

DP/13769/ED/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Suresh Khanderao Chavhanke S/o Sh. Khanderao Ganpat Chavhanke R/o B-157, Sector-50, Noida, UP** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 406/2022 U/S 153A/295A/298/34 IPC, PS Okhla Industrial Area, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Suresh Khanderao Chavhanke** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Suresh Khanderao Chavhanke** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Suresh Khanderao Chavhanke** of **FIR No. 406/2022 U/S 153A/295A/298/34 IPC, PS Okhla Industrial Area, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **29.10.2026.**

By Order,
Ms. Akansha Gautam
Judicial Magistrate-02, First Class
South East, Room No. 513
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

DP/13529/SE/2026(Court Matter)

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Bank Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Abhimanyu Choudhary/ Sonu Choudhary/ LBGHZ00005706417	Flat No. 1805, 18th Floor, Sun- 2, Migsun Ultimo, Plot No. GH-03, Sector- Omicorn-3, Greater Noida Uttar Pradesh- 201302/ September 24, 2026	February 24,2023 Rs. 51,42,444.00 /-	Delhi Ncr

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: September 29, 2026
Place: Delhi/ Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

GOVERNMENT OF CHHATTISGARH, WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT
OFFICE OF THE OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
SHIVNATH CIRCLE DURG (CHHATTISGARH)
e-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
eProcurement Portal: https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in

(1st Call)

System Tender No. :199840/NIT No. : 07/SAC/2026-27, Kawardha, Dated : 23.09.2026

Online Tenders are Invited for The Following Works up to 14.10.2026 at 17:30 Hour (IST) :-

Name of Work	:	Remodeling and Cement concrete lining of Main Canal from RD 0 to 2100 m with construction of 01 No. VRB, 01 No. Fall. Repair of structure, Repair of Sluice and fixing of colaba pipe of Chhirha Diversion Scheme in Block - Kawardha of District - Kabirdham
Probable Amount of Contract	:	**Rs. 108.62 Lakhs**

The details can be viewed and downloaded online directly from the Government of Chhattisgarh Integrated e-Procurement Portal (**https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in**)from **Date 30.09.2026, at 17:31 Hours (IST) onwards.**

NOTE :- All eligible/interested contractors/bidders are mandated to get enrolled on the Integrated e-procurement portal (**https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in**) and get approval on specific vendor class from PWD under Centralized Contractor/Supplier Registration in order to download the tender documents and participate in the subsequent bidding process.

Executive Engineer
Water Resources Division, Kawardha
Disst. Kabirdham (C.G.)
For, Superintending Engineer Shivnath Circle, Durg C.G.)

G 262703576/8

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Kavita Sabarwal Managine Director of Suparas Homz P.Ltd R/o H.No. B-44/1, Basement Jaina Tower-I, District Centre Janakpuri, Delhi-110058** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC No. 10745/2016 U/s 138 NI Act at PS: Tilak Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Kavita Sabarwal** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Kavita Sabarwal** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Kavita Sabarwal of CC No. 10745/2016 U/s 138 NI Act of PS: Tilak Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 27.11.2026.**

By order
Tanmay Batham
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
NI Act-03 West Distt Room No. 103,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/13547/WD/2026

OFFICE OF EXECUTIVE ENGINEER JAISINGHPUR DIVISION
H.P. PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT, JAISINGHPUR -176095
Fax: 01894-228031, e.mail: ee-jaipwd-hp@gov.in
e-Procurement Notice
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer, Jaisinghpur Division, HPPWD, Jaisinghpur on behalf of the Governor of Himachal Pradesh invites the online bids on percentage rate of following works from the eligible and approved Contactors/Firms registered with HPPWD Department:-.

S. No	Name of work	Estimated cost in Rs.	Earnest Money	Time Limit	Cost of tender form	Start date for downloading of bid	Deadline for submission of Bid
1	Construction of Health Sub Centre Building at Dagoh Tehsil Jaisinghpur Distt. Kangra (HP) (SH: C/O Main Building alongwith W.S, S.I, Rainwater Harvesting tank, site development and Septic tank)	8157254/-	163200/-	Twelve month	2000/-	07.10.26	12.10.26

The bidders are advised to note other details / Terms & conditions of tenders from the departmental website https://hptenders.gov.in. The Executive Engineer reserves the right to reject any tender or all tenders without assigning any reasons

HIM SUCHANA AVAM JAN SAMPARK

Executive Engineer
Jaisinghpur Division, HP.PWD., Jaisinghpur.
(On behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh)

Ro.No 3729/2026-2027

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
NATIONAL HIGHWAY DIVISION, RANCHI
Din Dayal Nagar, Booty Road, Ranchi - 834008
3rd CORRIGENDUM OF TENDER

This is to notify the concerned that the tender published in news paper by **PR 390136 Road(26-27)_D & PR 390402 (Road) 26-27(D)** with **Tender Reference Number- NH/RANCHI/SBD/2026-27/02** for the work **" Construction of drain in Km 3rd, 4th, 6th, 7th, 14th, 15th & 16th and culvert of chainage 3+200 of NH-143AG under Special Repair (SR) under under NH Division, Ranchi, Jharkhand for the year 2026-27"** has been revised. The ammended schedule is as follows:

S.No	Particulars	Publication in Portal	As amended for publication in portal
1.	Start of submission of online bid	30.09.2026 upto **10.30 A.M.**	14.10.2026 upto **10.30 A.M.**
2.	End of submission of online bid	14.10.2026 upto **17.00 P.M.**	28.10.2026 upto **17.00 P.M.**
3.	Opening of Bid	16.10.2026 at **15.00 P.M.**	30.10.2026 at **15.00 P.M.**

Executive Engineer
National Highway Division, Ranchi

PR 390680 Road(26-27)D

GOVERNMENT OF JHARKHAND
DEPARTMENT OF MINES AND GEOLOGY
DIRECTORATE OF GEOLOGY

NIT No. 04/2026-27 **Date**: 28.09.2026

S. No.	Particulars	Information
1.	Name of work	Supply and Installation of a High Energy Ball Mill
2.	Contact Person and Address for Communication	Director, Geology; Directorate of Geology, Department of Mines & Geology, Government of Jharkhand; Engineers' Hostel No-2, 2nd Floor, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004; E-mail ID: dir-geology@jharkhandmail.gov.in
3.	Cost of NIT	NIL
4.	Validity of the Rate/Price Offered by the Bidders	180 days
5.	Tender publication date	28.09.2026
6.	Last date of submission of Bids/NIT	13.10.2026 till 01:00 PM
7.	Bid/NIT opening date	13.10.2026 up to 03:30 PM.
8.	Period of issue of NIT	28.09.2026 to 13.10.2026
9.	Mode of Bid submission	The bid must be submitted through the Speed post/Registered post in a sealed envelope clearly mentioning the NIT reference number and the subject matter on the sealed envelope.
10.	Address of Bid submission	Directorate of Geology, Engineers' Hostel No-2, 2nd Floor, Dhurwa, Ranchi, Jharkhand, PIN-834004

Sd/- Director, Geology
Directorate of Geology,
Department of Mines & Geology,
Government of Jharkhand

PR.NO.390690 Mines and Geology(26-27):D



PATTINSON IS ALL SET TO REPRISE HIS ROLE AS THE CAPED CRUSADER IN MATT REEVES' FOLLOW-UP TO THE 2022 'THE BATMAN'

'Tough to have this version of Bruce outside of THAT WORLD'



Robert thinks his Batman will find it tough' to interact with other DC Universe characters

LOS ANGELES: Hollywood star Robert Pattinson said it'd be tough for his version of Batman to interact with other superheroes in filmmaker James Gunn's 'DC Cinematic Universe'.

Pattinson is all set to reprise his role as the Caped Crusader in Matt Reeves' follow-up to the 2022 'The Batman', which was more of a crime noir than a standard superhero action film.

"I think it'd be kind of tough to have this version of Bruce outside of that world. It is one of the only characters, I guess, because of the length of the shoot, but also it is such a specific kind of style; the tone of it gets inside you," he told the 'LADbible' outlet in an interview.

In the 2022 film, Pattinson's Bruce Wayne is shown in the second year as a vigilante in Gotham City as he hunts a sadistic serial killer named the Riddler, who is targeting the city's corrupt elite. Instead of using a public persona to hide his identity, Pattinson's Bruce is a recluse and ignores his corporate duties and society.

Pattinson also struggled to separate his normal life from his vigilante persona, letting Batman consume his entire existence. "I remember that happened to me the last time I did it; it took a while. You're just in the dark the whole time. Both mood-wise and light-wise, I can't see anything for like months. It does affect you; you feel strange afterwards," he added.

'The Batman Part II' is in the production stage and is set to be released on February 18, 2028. In an interview with 'Collider', Pattinson said the movie would be a 'real left turn from the first film'.

"The first one was a different take on a Batman movie and this one is another... It's a real left turn from the first one." PTI

Salman speaks on misuse of AI

The Bollywood actor said AI's progress has become 'scary'



NEW DELHI: Bollywood superstar Salman Khan slammed the misuse of Artificial Intelligence by a section of users and said those making fake videos should be put behind bars. The actor addressed the issue on 'Bigg Boss 20' and said strict measures should be taken against violators. The video has been circulated online.

Khan said AI's progress has become 'scary'. "Someone made an AI video or did AI voice dubbing; it is wrong. AI has progressed so much; it is very scary. It is a very serious thing," he was heard saying.

THE ACTOR ADDED THAT STRICT MEASURES SHOULD BE TAKEN AGAINST VIOLATORS

He added, "You said something and someone used AI to edit it and abuse. You know what they're doing? AI videos bana rahe hain yeh. Bahut saare logon ke (They're making AI videos of so many people) and even I am there in the AI video."

Khan said there has to be censorship. "Now, people who don't know it is AI-generated content might post that Salman Khan was there," he added. PTI

IMDB TRENDING PEOPLE IN INDIA

Ankur Rathee, Kareena Kapoor lead this week's list

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

The 'IMDb Trending People in India' list this week puts the spotlight on actors and filmmakers who are trending among fans with their recent releases.

Ankur Rathee of 'Best of the Best' leads the chart at the 1st spot, while Kareena Kapoor makes a strong showing at the 3rd position with the theatrical release of 'Daayra'.

Among the other titles making a strong showing this week, Harleen Sethi of 'Shaque: Trust No One' trends at the 7th spot, while Radhika Madan, part of 'Lust Stories 3', features at 13th rank.



HARLEEN SETHI OF 'SHAQUE: TRUST NO ONE' TRENDS AT THE 7TH SPOT

The cast and director of the much-talked-about 'The Paradise' also make a notable appearance on the list, with director Srikanth Odela at the 8th spot, Raghav Juyal at the 9th position, Nani at the 10th rank and Kayadu Lohar at the 15th position.

SQUARE YARDS

Akshaye buys an apartment in Mumbai for Rs 33.26 crore

The transaction was registered in September 2026

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 28

Indian actor Akshaye Vinod Khanna has purchased an apartment on Malabar Hill, Mumbai, for Rs 33.26 crore, according to property registration documents reviewed by Square Yards on the website of the Inspector General of Registration (IGR) at https://igrmaharashtra.gov.in. The transaction was registered in September 2026.

Malabar Hill is one of Mumbai's most prestigious and sought-after residential neighbourhoods, known for its prime South Mumbai location, premium residences and serene surroundings. Situated along the Arabian Sea, the area offers excellent connectivity to key commercial and lifestyle destinations through major roads such as Nepean Sea Road, Walkeshwar Road and Pedder Road, with easy access to Marine Drive, Nariman Point and Colaba.

Over the years, Malabar Hill has evolved into an exclusive residential destination, characterised by luxury apartment towers, high-end residences and established neighbourhoods. Its proximity to major business districts such as Nariman Point, Fort and Lower Parel makes it particularly attractive to senior professionals, business leaders and high-net-worth individuals. The area also benefits from strong social infrastructure, with reputed schools, hospitals, premium restaurants, shopping destinations and recreational spaces in and around the neighbourhood.



THE PROPERTY IS LOCATED AT 30 LITTLE GIBBS, MALABAR HILL ROAD

Iconic landmarks such as Hanging Gardens, Kamala Nehru Park, Banganga Tank and Walkeshwar Temple further enhance its appeal. The combination of sea-facing residences, limited availability of premium real estate, established infrastructure, and a prestigious address makes Malabar Hill a preferred choice for luxury homebuyers and investors seeking exclusivity and long-term value in South Mumbai.

According to the IGR property registration documents reviewed by Square Yards, the property is located at 30 Little Gibbs, Malabar Hill Road, Mumbai. The purchased apartment features a carpet area of 2,341.39 sq. ft. (217.52 sq. m.), along with a total balcony area of 175.45 sq. ft. (16.29 sq. m.), taking the total area to 2,516.84 sq. ft. (233.82 sq. m.). The property also includes three parking units. The transaction incurred a stamp duty payment of Rs 1.99 crore and registration charges of Rs 30,000.

Akshaye Vinod Khanna is an acclaimed Indian actor, known for his versatile performances and a distinguished career in Hindi cinema spanning several decades. The son of veteran actor Vinod Khanna, Akshaye has established his own identity in the industry through a diverse range of roles across genres, earning recognition for his understated screen presence and nuanced performances. He has appeared in several notable films, including 'Hulchul', 'Race', 'Gandhi', 'My Father', 'Dil Chahta Hai', 'Drishyam' and others. Known for his ability to portray both dramatic and complex characters, he has maintained a relatively private lifestyle away from the spotlight.

TAYLOR BECOMES MOST-AWARDED ARTIST IN MTV VMAS HISTORY



Swift dedicated her top prize to the late Dolly Parton

Taylor Swift broke records at the 2026 MTV Video Music Awards, as she is known to do. The pop powerhouse received the inaugural Artist Director Honours on Sunday night, becoming the most-awarded artist in VMA history.

Previously, she was tied with Beyoncé for the title, with 30 VMAs each. The new award is meant to recognise artists 'whose work behind the camera has expanded the possibilities of music video and advanced the art of visual storytelling'.

She also took home the top prize of the night, 'Video of the Year', for 'The Fate of Ophelia' from her album 'The Life of a Showgirl'. Swift dedicated the award to the 'ultimate showgirl', the late Dolly Parton. Swift also debuted the music video for her new song, 'Patient Zero', during the award show. She directed the visual, which stars Colin Farrell and Dakota Johnson. Johnson and Swift portray mirror images of each other. 'Patient Zero' is also her first single since marrying Kansas City Chiefs tight end Travis Kelce at Madison Square Garden in July.

TEYANA TAYLOR PRESENTED THE FIRST AWARD FOR 'BEST POP' TO LISA FOR 'DREAM', FEATURING KENTARO SAKAGUCHI

The two-hour show was broadcast live on CBS from the Peacock Theatre in Los Angeles.

Madonna opened the starry award show and won big. "It is mother," were the first words uttered by Madonna as she opened the VMAs with her 2026 single 'Bring Your Love' alongside collaborator Sabrina Carpenter. Later in the night, the pair won the award for 'Best Collaboration' for the song.

When it came time for her return to the stage to accept the award for artist of the year, Madonna began with, "First of all, I would like to thank my fingers because I can always count on them." Returning a third time to accept for best dance, she simply said, "I came alive on the dance floor. We're all equal on the dance floor."

If her aim was to bring the dance floor to the award show stage, Madonna did exactly that in her opening number and then some, when Charli XCX emerged from a club bathroom to perform their reworked version of 'Danceteria'. Around them? A trove of dancers and various famous friends, including actor Debi Mazar, Sombr and Julia Garner.

The show, which was delayed 20 minutes by a tight NFL game, wasted no time getting heart rates up. Snoop Dogg, a 13-time VMAs nominee and three-time winner, emerged as host shortly thereafter.

Teyana Taylor then presented the first award for 'Best Pop' to LISA for 'Dream', featuring Kentaro Sakaguchi.

Performances include a tribute to Dolly Parton. There was always going to be a big musical tribute to Dolly Parton. AGENCIES